

The הגדה של Passover פסח Haggadah

*A new translation with
commentary for the seder*

ברוך אליעזר בן אברהם
Baruch Speiser



הגדה של פסח

The Passover Haggadah

A new translation with
commentary for the Seder

ברוך אליעזר בן אברהם
Baruch Speiser

Cover design by Tziona Speiser

לזכר רחל בת נחום והינדא לאה

Dedicated to the memory of my mother,
Lora Rachel Barry Speiser Goldberg

*Thank you to my wife, Ashira,
for everything and everything;
and to my children,
who bring me joy*

THE REMOVAL OF CHAMETZ

Formal preparations for Passover begin the night before the Seder, starting with the process for removing chametz from one's domain. This not only includes the location where one will be celebrating Passover, but from all locations in one's domain, such as a workplace, automobile, or alternate residences.

Because the obligation on Passover is to own no chametz, the sages instituted that one can sell their chametz before Passover, in order so that one will not actually own any remaining chametz in their house and will therefore fulfill the commandment of removing chametz from their domain. However, prior to this institution, the sages relied on active removal of chametz from one's ownership by destroying it. This process remains an essential activity prior to the onset of Passover. It begins with the search for the chametz, and then concludes with its destruction and nullification the next morning.

The search for chametz is traditionally conducted in the dark, using a candle for light. Many authorities permit the use of a flashlight. While the origin of this is likely historical – the invention of modern lighting is a recent phenomenon and so the use of a candle in the evening was simply a necessity – some claim that the increased contrast of the spotlight effect of a light in the dark makes the search more effective. Others claim it is metaphorical; that Passover should begin in darkness with only the first glimmer of light to show the way. Regardless of the reasoning, the search is still traditionally conducted in the dark to this day.

The purpose of this search is to find any last chametz that has not yet been discovered and destroy it, so that the location will be chametz-free

ahead of the holiday. However, it is clear that by this time, most people have already sufficiently cleaned their houses for Passover and are unlikely to actually have random chametz remaining. In order to prevent the recitation of an unnecessary blessing, someone should hide chametz ahead of time, so that some will indeed be located during the search. Although this would technically only require hiding one piece of chametz, the tradition was established to hide ten pieces for the sake of providing a substantive ritual. While conducting the search, any unexpectedly discovered chametz should be gathered as well. Many use a feather as part of the search to sweep up the crumbs, even if only performatively.

Although the recited blessing specifically refers to the burning of chametz, this is only because burning is the simplest mechanism for achieving the end result of possessing no chametz.

After preparations for the search have been completed and the participants are ready to begin, recite the following blessing:

בְּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ	Blessed are You, The Eternal our
הָעוֹלָם אֲשֶׁר קִדְּשָׁנוּ	God, King of the Universe; Who
בְּמִצְוֹתָיו וְצִוָּנוּ עַל בְּעוֹר	has sanctified us with His
חֵמֶץ.	commandments and has
	commanded us regarding the
	burning of chametz.

After all of the intentionally hidden chametz is found and the search is effectively completed, the found chametz is set aside for destruction the next morning and the following paragraph is recited.

This proclamation is the first stage of ensuring that no chametz remains in one's possession before beginning the Passover holiday. It should be noted that the passage is in Aramaic – not Hebrew – because it was intended to be proclaimed in the vernacular, and Aramaic was the

common language of the time. Because the proclamation is driven by intention rather than ritual, it is recommended that all participants recite the following passage in whatever language they understand.

כָּל חֲמִירָא וְחֲמִיעָא דְאַכָּא	Any chametz, leavened
בְּרִשּׁוֹתַי דְּלֹא חֲמִיתָהּ וְדִלֵּא	products, or leavening agents in
בְּעֶרְתָּהּ לְבִטּוּל וְלַהּוּי הַפְּקָר	my possession that I have not
כְּעֶפְרָא דְאַרְעָא.	seen, have not destroyed, or am
	not aware of - I hereby nullify,
	disown, and consider completely
	irrelevant to me; and carry no
	more significance to me than
	dust of the earth.

The remaining procedures for the removal of chametz continue the following morning.

The chametz gathered during the previous night's search, along with any other additional chametz still in one's possession that has not been sold or given away, should be destroyed, traditionally by burning it. However, if one is unable to burn it, any other means of destruction that removes it from the property is valid; such as feeding it to fish in a lake, disposal in a public garbage receptacle, and so on.

After the chametz has been destroyed (or even while it is burning), the following paragraph is recited.

Like the previous evening's proclamation, this is the most essential aspect of this entire process, for it fully certifies that there is no longer any chametz in one's possession, even if one can physically see it (such as in the case where it has been sold to a third party and, despite being visible, is no longer owned by the resident).

Even if one does not have any chametz to destroy, or even if one forgot to perform any previous step in the search for chametz, this paragraph should be recited. Similar to the previous proclamation, it is recommended that all participants recite the following passage in whatever language they understand.

כָּל חֲמִירָא וְחֲמִיעָא דְאַפָּא	Any chametz, leavened
בְּרִשּׁוֹתַי דְּחֲמִתָּהּ וְדָלָא	products, or leavening agents in
חֲמִתָּהּ דְּבִעֲרִיתָהּ וְדָלָא	my possession that I have seen
בִּעֲרִיתָהּ לְבִטּוּל וְלַהּוּי הַפְּקָר	or have not seen, have destroyed
כְּעֶפְרָא דְאַרְעָא.	or have not destroyed, or am
	aware of or not aware of - I
	hereby nullify, disown, and
	consider completely irrelevant
	to me; and carry no more
	significance to me than dust of
	the earth.

With this final proclamation, one has fulfilled their obligation to remove any chametz from their domain prior to Passover.

According to the established Hebrew calendar, the first night of Passover can only fall on a Friday, Saturday, Monday, or Wednesday night. For Jews in the Diaspora who celebrate two full days of yom tov (the holiday portion of the festival), that means that when Passover begins on a Wednesday night, the holiday can directly lead into the Sabbath. On years when this occurs, one should make an eiruv tavshillin, a halachic designation that would lose meaning in translation.

On years when Passover does not directly lead into the Sabbath, an eiruv tavshillin is unnecessary and should not be designated.

Jewish law stipulates that one may not cook on the Sabbath, but one may cook on yom tov. However, even so, one may only prepare food for that same day of yom tov; not even for the second day of yom tov nor the day after the holiday is over. This is so that one does not get bogged down by excessive preparation over the holiday and demean the restful nature of the day; only what is necessary for that day's meals is permissible.

This presents a logistical problem whenever any holiday leads directly into the Sabbath: when will someone prepare food for the Sabbath, since all of the preceding days only allow food to be prepared for the same day's meals? Due to this logistical challenge, the sages instituted a halachic workaround called an *eiruv tavshillin*. This allows one to prepare food for Sabbath during the holiday by officially starting the Sabbath preparations prior to the onset of the holiday, and so any food preparation over the holiday is simply an extension of the preparation that was already started before the holiday began. This allows one to prepare food for the Sabbath on the holiday, but still limits one from preparing food for after the Sabbath is over.

Prior to the onset of Passover, one designates two or more cooked or baked foods that will specifically be eaten on the Sabbath as the *eiruv tavshillin*. Many people have a custom to use a piece of matzah and a hard-boiled egg (since it could be considered a bare minimum to meet the requirements), but in practice, one should choose cooked or baked foods that are intentionally going to be served at the Sabbath meal. Many people have the custom to eat the *eiruv tavshillin* specifically as part of their *Seudat Shlishit*, the Third Sabbath Meal, which is typically eaten in the late afternoon before the Sabbath ends.

While holding the cooked and/or baked foods, one should recite the following blessing and then the subsequent declaration. The declaration, originally written in the vernacular Aramaic, should ideally be recited in a language that one understands.

בְּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם, אֲשֶׁר קִדְּשָׁנוּ בְּמִצְוֹתָיו וְצִוָּנוּ עַל מִצְוַת עֵרוּב.	Blessed are You, The Eternal our God, King of the Universe; Who has sanctified us with His commandments and has commanded us regarding the mitzvah of <i>eiruv</i> .
---	---

בְּיָדֵינוּ עֵרוּבָא, יְהִיא שְׂרִי לָנָא לְאַפּוּי וּלְבִשּׁוּלִי וּלְאַטְמוּנִי וּלְתַקְוִנִי וּלְאַדְלוּקִי שְׂרָגָא וּלְמַעֲבַד כָּל-צִרְכָּנָא, מִיּוֹם טוֹב לְשַׁבָּת.	With this <i>eiruv</i> , it is permissible to bake, cook, insulate food, prepare utensils, light candles, and do whatever is needed for the Sabbath during the holiday.
--	---

*Set aside the foods designated as the *eiruv tavshillin* and serve them during an upcoming Sabbath meal.*

As with the Sabbath and all other holidays, one should light at least two candles to usher in the holiday.

Light at least two candles and recite the following blessings.

On Friday night, the addition for the Sabbath should be included.

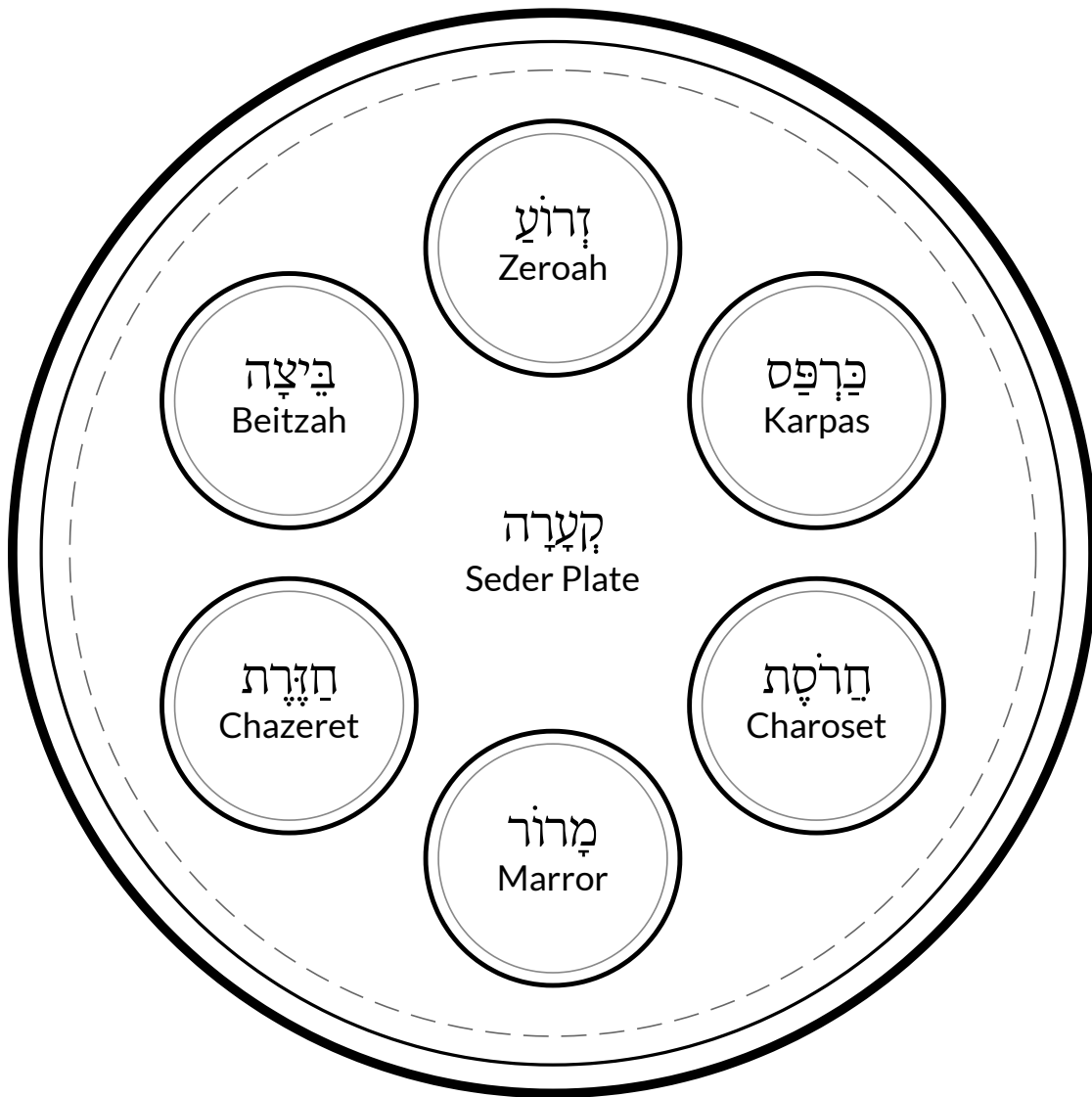
בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי, אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם, אֲשֶׁר קִדְּשָׁנוּ בְּמִצְוֹתָיו, וְצִוָּנוּ לְהַדְלִיק נֵר שֶׁל (שַׁבָּת וְ) יוֹם-טוֹב.	Blessed are You, The Eternal our God, King of the Universe; Who has sanctified us with His commandments and has commanded us to light candles for (the Sabbath and) the holiday.
---	---

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם, שֶׁהַחַיָּנוּ וְקִיָּמָנוּ וְהַגִּיעָנוּ לַזְמַן הַזֶּה.	Blessed are You, The Eternal our God, King of the Universe; Who has granted us life, sustained us, and enabled us to reach this occasion.
--	--

Many include their own personal silent prayers as part of this ritual.

THE SEDER PLATE

According to Jewish law, the Seder Plate requires at least four components: Zeroah, Beitzah, Marror, and Charoset; but has no strict requirements for its layout. The diagram below reflects only one of the many traditions.



- **Zeroah** - Roasted shankbone
- **Karpas** - Vegetable for dipping in saltwater, most use parsley or celery
- **Charoset** - Dip resembling mortar made from fruit, nuts and wine
- **Marror** - Bitter herbs such as endive or raddichio; many use horseradish
- **Chazeret** - Romaine lettuce or other alternative leafy marror
- **Beitzah** - Roasted egg

קַדֵּשׁ	Kadesh
וּרְחֹץ	Urchatz
כַּרְפָּס	Karpas
יַחֲצֵץ	Yachatz
מַגִּיד	Maggid
רַחֲצָה	Rachtzah
מוֹצִיא מַצָּה	Mozti Matzah
מָרֹר	Marror
כוֹרֵךְ	Korech
שְׁלַחַן עוֹרֵךְ	Shulchan Orech
צִפּוּן	Tzafun
בָּרֵךְ	Barech
הַלֵּל	Hallel
נִרְצָה	Nirtzah

The Seder begins with Kadesh. Like all Jewish festivals, there is an obligation to sanctify the essence of the day over wine. If one prefers, grape juice may be used in place of wine at all times during the Seder (according to most opinions). On the Sabbath, the indicated additions should be included.

The translation that follows is intended to reflect the unique and distinctive composition in the original Hebrew.

Include on Friday night:

וַיְהִי עֶרֶב וַיְהִי בֹקֶר יוֹם הַשִּׁשִּׁי: "It was evening and then morning on the sixth day:

וַיִּכְלּוּ הַשָּׁמַיִם וְהָאָרֶץ וְכָל צִבְאָם. וַיִּכַּל אֱלֹהִים בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי מְלַאכְתּוֹ אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וַיִּשְׁבֹּת בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי מִכָּל מְלַאכְתּוֹ אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה. וַיְבָרֶךְ אֱלֹהִים אֶת יוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי וַיְקַדֵּשׁ אוֹתוֹ כִּי בּוֹ שָׁבַת מְכָל מְלַאכְתּוֹ אֲשֶׁר בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים לַעֲשׂוֹת.

"The heavens and the earth and all of the elements of the universe were completed. On the seventh day God finished His craft which He had made, and He rested on the seventh day from all His craft that He had made. God blessed the seventh day and sanctified it, for on it He rested from all His craft that God created to function."

סְבָרִי מָרְנָן וְרַבָּנָן וְרַבּוֹתֵי: Attention all:

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְיָ אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם, בּוֹרֵא פְרִי הַגֶּפֶן. Blessed are You, The Eternal our God, King of the Universe; Who creates the fruit of the vine.

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ
 הָעוֹלָם, אֲשֶׁר בָּחַר בָּנוּ מִכָּל
 עַם וְרוֹמְמָנוּ מִכָּל לָשׁוֹן
 וְקִדְּשָׁנוּ בְּמִצְוֹתָיו. וַתִּתֵּן לָנוּ
 יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ בְּאַהֲבָה (שִׁבְתוֹת
 לְמִנוּחָה וּ) מוֹעֲדִים לְשִׂמְחָה,
 חַגִּים וְזִמְנִים לְשִׂשׁוֹן, אֶת
 (יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת הַזֶּה וְאֶת) יוֹם
 חַג הַמִּצּוֹת הַזֶּה, זְמַן
 חֵירוּתֵנוּ (בְּאַהֲבָה) מִקָּרָא
 קֹדֶשׁ, זֵכֶר לִיציאת מִצְרָיִם.
 כִּי בָנוּ בְּחִרְתָּ וְאוֹתָנוּ
 קִדְּשָׁתָּ מִכָּל הָעַמִּים, (וְשִׁבְתָּ
 וּ) מוֹעֲדֵי קֹדֶשְׁךָ (בְּאַהֲבָה
 וּבְרָצוֹן) בְּשִׂמְחָה וּבְשִׂשׁוֹן
 הִנַּחֲלָתָנוּ. בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי,
 מִקֹּדֶשׁ (הַשַּׁבָּת וּ) יִשְׂרָאֵל
 וְהַזִּמְנִים.

Blessed are You, The Eternal our
 God, King of the Universe; Who
 has chosen us from among all
 the people, and lifted us from
 among many cultures, and
 sanctified us through His
 commandments. You, The
 Eternal, have given us with love
 (Sabbaths for rest and) festivals
 for happiness, feasts and festive
 seasons for rejoicing, this
 (Sabbath day and this) day of the
 "Festival of Matzot"; this season
 of our freedom (with love) which
 we can declare holy,
 commemorating the Exodus
 from Egypt. For You have chosen
 us and sanctified us from all the
 nations; (and Sabbath and) Your
 holy festivals — (with love and
 favor,) with happiness and joy —
 we have inherited. Blessed are
 You, The Eternal, who sanctifies
 (the Sabbath and) Israel and the
 festive seasons.

Include on Saturday night (a Havdalah candle is required):

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ
 הָעוֹלָם, בּוֹרֵא מְאוּרֵי הָאֵשׁ.
 בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ
 הָעוֹלָם הַמְבַדִּיל בֵּין קֹדֶשׁ

Blessed are You, The Eternal our
 God, King of the Universe; Who
 creates the illuminations of fire.

Blessed are You, The Eternal our
 God, King of the Universe; Who
 differentiates between sacred
 and mundane, between light and

לְחֹל, בֵּין אֹר לְחֹשֶׁךְ, בֵּין
 יִשְׂרָאֵל לְעַמִּים, בֵּין יוֹם
 הַשְּׁבִיעִי לַשַּׁשֶּׁת יָמֵי
 הַמַּעֲשֶׂה. בֵּין קִדְשַׁת שַׁבָּת
 לְקִדְשַׁת יוֹם טוֹב הַבְּדִלָּה,
 וְאֵת יוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי מִשְׁשַׁת
 יָמֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה קִדְשָׁהּ.
 הַבְּדִלָּה וְקִדְשָׁהּ אֶת עַמְּךָ
 יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּקִדְשָׁתְךָ. בָּרוּךְ
 אַתָּה יְיָ הַמַּבְדִּיל בֵּין קֹדֶשׁ
 לְקֹדֶשׁ.

darkness, between Israel and the nations, between the seventh day and the six days of the Creation. Between the holiness of the Sabbath and the holiness of festivals You have made a distinction; and You have sanctified the seventh day above the six days of Creation. You have set apart and made holy Your people Israel with Your Holiness. Blessed are You, The Eternal, who distinguishes between different sanctities.

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְיָ אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ
 הָעוֹלָם, שֶׁחַיֵּינוּ וְקִיָּמָנוּ
 וְהִגִּיעָנוּ לְזֶמֶן הַזֶּה.

Blessed are You, The Eternal our God, King of the Universe; Who has granted us life, sustained us, and enabled us to reach this occasion.

Drink the cup of wine. One should lean to the left while drinking.

The Seder continues with a ceremonious washing of the hands.

Unlike most hand washing rituals, Urchatz mandates that no blessing be recited. The halachic origin of this particular ritual is related to complicated laws of *Tumah v'Tahara*¹ that are no longer applicable in the modern era; and is in fact not at all related to the laws of Passover.²

However, the author(s) of the Haggadah chose specifically to codify the inclusion of this obscure ritual practice for the very obscurity that surrounds it. The true value of Urchatz in the Seder is not that it fulfills obscure halachic requirements for which few understand; but rather that it is in-and-of-itself a symbol of obscurity.

The purpose of Urchatz is clear: the Seder is designed, organized, and codified to pique our curiosity. The ambiguous relevance of Urchatz is deliberate; it forces to question it and its origin. Through this, the Hagaddah sets the tone and for the remainder of the Seder: Participants should be inquisitive. All who experience the Seder are encouraged to ask questions, to delve deeper into the meaning of the Hagaddah text, and to not merely read the Hagaddah but instead learn it.

Wash your hands in the traditional manner, without reciting any blessings:

Fill a cup with water, and then pour it over each hand twice.

(Some have the custom to pour three times.)

Then dry your hands.

¹*Tumah* is most often poorly translated into English using nomenclature such as "impure", "unclean", or "defiled". All of these are improper; *Tumah* is actually more of an "essence of death", or a "lack of life". Examples that demonstrate this concept are the fact that a human corpse is the strongest source of *Tumah*, and that various divinely-caused illnesses

such as *Tzara'at* (most often mistranslated as leprosy) and *Zav* (another divinely-caused disease) result in the inability to procreate.

²The obscure law of *Urchatz* is related to washing one's hands before dipping edibles into a liquid. This is because edibles can only contract *Tumah* after they have been exposed to one of seven liquids (called *machshirin*): dew, water, wine, oil, blood, milk, and honey. When any of these liquids touch food, the food is then susceptible to *Tumah* contamination. In ancient times, it was commonplace to not wash vegetables until immediately prior to eating, so that they would remain incapable of contracting *Tumah*. Because most meals start with the traditional breaking of bread — which is preceded by a ritual washing of the hands — there is no special concern that *Tumah* will be transmitted to the vegetables that are washed immediately prior to consumption.

However, the Sages understood that there are occasions where one eats vegetables dipped in liquid outside the context of a meal, so it is possible that one's hands could be *Tamei*. As a result, the Sages instituted that one wash their hands before dipping foods, so that one's hands would not be *Tamei* when they dip their food in liquid. In this fashion, the foodstuffs would remain *Tahor*, and therefore *Kohanim* at the table could eat without concern for making themselves *Tamei*; which could interfere with other aspects of their daily rituals.

As noted, the origins of these laws were established in a time when everyday individuals were concerned about their status as *Tamei* or *Tahor*. Nowadays, however, these concerns are of less general relevance. Nonetheless, their inclusion in the Seder inspires a foray into complex areas of Jewish law, and as noted in the general commentary; this sets the appropriate tone for the evening as we are encouraged to ask questions.

By deliberately including an obscure ritual from outside the context of Passover itself, the Haggadah asks us to expand our horizons and look more broadly at all Jewish ceremonies and customs with an inquisitive

eye. What do they mean? What are they supposed to teach us? What feelings are they supposed to invoke? From the very beginning of the Seder, with just a simple hand-washing ritual, the Haggadah aims to broaden the scope of self-reflection and engagement with our history, customs, and laws.

*The Seder continues with Karpas —
which is not quite an appetizer but can serve to whet one's appetite.*

The ritual of Karpas involves eating a vegetable dipped in saltwater, representing the many tears shed by our ancestors during their slavery in Egypt. While all vegetables are acceptable for use in Karpas, it is recommended that one use a green vegetable, to additionally symbolize Passover as *Chag HaAviv*, the Festival of Spring, and the new growth and new life that the season brings. For this reason, many customarily use parsley, celery, or other green vegetables that may be growing at this time of the year.

Most Jewish legal authorities recommend that one only eat a relatively insubstantial amount for Karpas. The principle reason is that one should save their appetite for the matzah which will be eaten later.

Dip the chosen vegetable in the saltwater and recite the following blessing:

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם, בּוֹרֵא פְּרִי הָאֲדָמָה.	Blessed are You, The Eternal our God, King of the Universe; Who creates the fruit of the earth.
---	---

Eat the vegetable.

*The Seder continues with Yachatz,
which is the last precursor to the retelling of the Exodus.*

The plate of three matzot is retrieved, and the middle matzah is pulled out and broken in half. The larger of the two halves is set aside as the Afikoman, and will be used later in the evening. The smaller of the two is returned to the plate of matzot, in between the two whole matzot.

Unlike most festival meals, where it is customary to use two loaves of bread to fulfill the general concept of *Lechem Mishneh* (literally *doubled bread*), on Passover we use three matzot. One reason is simply mathematical: If one breaks one matzah for Yachatz, two whole matzot are still required in order to fulfill *Lechem Mishneh*; hence the need for three matzot.

The main purpose of Yachatz is to set the tone for the beginning of Maggid. While the Jews were enslaved in Egypt, their national character and spirit was cracked, broken, shattered, and split. The process of the redemption was to pick up the remains of their spirit and find a future together. For this reason, the larger broken piece is set aside for the Afikoman, to serve as a reminder that in the end, we always leave behind the remnants of our troubles and move toward greatness.

The core of the Hagaddah begins with Maggid, in which the participants in the Seder recount various aspects of the Exodus. Individuals are encouraged to supplement the text with discussion, personal accounts of freedom, questions, or any other material that provides a meaningful Seder experience. Many introduce their own customs, or include customs of their guests.

The most important objective of the entire Seder is to teach children about the miraculous and divine methods that were used to save us from slavery. Children should be encouraged to participate at their individual level with songs, games, activities, or stories that help them feel as though they are contributing to the Seder. It is strongly recommended that you pause between paragraphs to ask a child a question, or to ask for them to reflect on something that was just read. The more that children are engaged, the more one fulfills the true directive of the Seder.

Maggid is arranged and written in a Talmudic fashion. Because of this oblique style, it is likely that most readers will have difficulty understanding why the Haggadah flows from one topic to the next. In addition, many of the nuances of the text are lost in translation. Therefore, for clarity, the English text provided for the various passages is not always a precise translation of the Hebrew text. Instead, this Haggadah opts to use an elucidated translation with embedded commentary that more clearly delineates the didactic nature of the Hebrew text, its intent, and its meaning.

Reveal the matzah and raise it for all to see, declaring the following:

הָא לַחֲמַא עֲנִיָּא דִּי אֲכָלוּ אֲבֹהֵתָנָא בְּאֶרֶץ דְּמִצְרַיִם. כָּל דְּכָפִין יִיתִי וְיִיכֹל, כָּל דְּצָרִיד יִיתִי וְיִפְסַח. הַשְׁתָּא הָכָא, לְשָׁנָה הַבָּאָה בְּאֶרֶץ דִּישְׂרָאֵל. הַשְׁתָּא עֲבָדִי, לְשָׁנָה הַבָּאָה בְּנֵי חֹרִין.	This is the bread of affliction that our fathers ate in the land of Egypt. Whoever is hungry, let him or her come and eat; whoever is in need, let him or her come and participate in the Passover Seder. This year we are here; next year we hope to be in the land of Israel. This year we might as well be slaves; next year we hope to truly be free people.
--	---

The matzah is again covered, and the second cup of wine is poured but will be drunk later. Many have the custom to remove the Seder plate from the table, if only to have children ask why it is removed.

An individual is designated to read or recite the four questions, usually the youngest child capable of doing so. Many have the custom that each child should recite the four questions; and participants should be encouraged to supplement with their own inquiries as well.

מָה נִשְׁתַּנָּה הַלַּיְלָה הַזֶּה מִכָּל הַלַּיְלוֹת? שְׁבֹכָל הַלַּיְלוֹת אָנוּ אוֹכְלִין חֶמֶץ וּמָצָה, הַלַּיְלָה הַזֶּה - כָּל מָצָה!	Why is this night different from all other nights? On all other nights we eat chametz or matzah, but tonight we only eat matzah.
---	--

שֶׁבֶּכֶל הַלֵּילֹת אָנוּ אוֹכְלִין
שֶׁאֵר יָרְקוֹת, הַלֵּילָה הַזֶּה -
מָרֹר!

On all other nights we eat other vegetables, but tonight we only eat bitter ones.

שֶׁבֶּכֶל הַלֵּילֹת אֵין אָנוּ
מִטְבִּילִין אֶפִּילוֹ פַּעַם אַחַת,
הַלֵּילָה הַזֶּה - שְׁתֵּי פַעַמִּים!

On all other nights we don't dip our food even once, but tonight we do it twice.

שֶׁבֶּכֶל הַלֵּילֹת אָנוּ אוֹכְלִין
בֵּין יוֹשְׁבִין וּבֵין מְסַבִּין,
הַלֵּילָה הַזֶּה - כָּלָנוּ מְסַבִּין!

On all other nights we eat in any position, but tonight we eat only while reclining.

WHO IS REQUIRED TO FULFILL THE COMMANDMENT TO RETELL THE EXODUS?

The matzah is partially uncovered.

If the Seder plate was removed from the table, it should be returned.

עֲבָדִים הָייֵנוּ לְפָרַעַה
בְּמִצְרַיִם, וַיּוֹצֵאֵנוּ יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ
מִשָּׁם בְּיָד חֲזָקָה וּבְזְרוּעַ
נְטוּיָה. וְאֵלֹנוּ לֹא הוֹצִיא
הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא אֶת
אֲבוֹתֵינוּ מִמִּצְרַיִם, הֲרִי אָנוּ
וּבְנֵינוּ וּבְנֵי בְנֵינוּ מְשֻׁעָבָדִים
הָייֵנוּ לְפָרַעַה בְּמִצְרַיִם.
וְאֶפִּילוֹ כָּלָנוּ חֲכָמִים, כָּלָנוּ
נְבוֹנִים, כָּלָנוּ זִקְנִים, כָּלָנוּ
יֹדְעִים אֶת הַתּוֹרָה, מִצְוָה

We used to be Pharaoh's slaves in Egypt, but The Eternal our God took us out from there with a strong hand and an outstretched arm. If the Holy and Blessed One had not taken our ancestors out of Egypt, then we, our children and our grandchildren would have remained enslaved to Pharaoh in Egypt. Even if all of us were wise, or all of us were insightful, or all of us knew the Torah, we would still be commanded to relate the Exodus from Egypt. Furthermore, anyone who

עֲלִינוּ לְסֵפֶר בִּיצִיַּאת
מִצְרַיִם. וְכָל הַמְרָבָה לְסֵפֶר
בִּיצִיַּאת מִצְרַיִם הָיָה זֶה
מִשְׁבַּח.

dives into the story of the Exodus is praiseworthy.

The following anecdote supports this theme. Rabbi Akiva, who was a convert, did not descend from any enslaved Jews. Rabbi Eliezer, Rabbi Yehoshua, Rabbi Elazar ben Azaryah, and Rabbi Tarphon all came from the tribe of Levi; the only Jewish tribe not enslaved in Egypt. Despite the fact that none of their ancestors were slaves and that they represented the greatest Jewish scholarship of their era, they nonetheless spent all night reviewing the Exodus in order to fulfill the commandment to the best of their ability. The Haggadah also tangentially details some of their discussions.

מַעֲשֵׂה בְרַבִּי אֶלְיעֶזֶר וְרַבִּי
יְהוֹשֻׁעַ וְרַבִּי אֶלְעָזָר בֶּן
עֲזַרְיָה וְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וְרַבִּי
טַרְפוֹן שֶׁהָיוּ מְסַבִּין בְּבֵית
בְּרַק, וְהָיוּ מְסַפְּרִים בִּיצִיַּאת
מִצְרַיִם כָּל אוֹתוֹ הַלַּיְלָה עַד
שֶׁבָּאוּ תַלְמִידֵיהֶם וְאָמְרוּ
לָהֶם: רַבּוֹתֵינוּ, הֲגִיעַ זְמַן
קְרִיַּאת שְׁמַע שֶׁל שַׁחֲרִית.

Rabbi Eliezer, Rabbi Yehoshua, Rabbi Elazar ben Azaryah, Rabbi Akiva and Rabbi Tarphon were once together at a seder in B'nei Berak. They were expounding upon the Exodus from Egypt the entire night, until their students interrupted them: "Rabbis, it is time to recite the morning Shema."

אָמַר רַבִּי אֶלְעָזָר בֶּן עֲזַרְיָה:
הָיָה אֲנִי כְּבֹן שִׁבְעִים שָׁנָה,
וְלֹא זָכִיתִי שֶׁתֹּאמַר יְצִיַּאת

During this discussion, Rabbi Eleazar ben Azaryah mentioned: "Here I am, nearly seventy years old; yet I was never able to prove that the Exodus from Egypt must

מִצָּרִים בַּלַּיְלוֹת עַד שְׂדֵרֶשֶׁה
בֶּן זֹמָא: שְׁנֵאָמַר, לְמַעַן
תִּזְכֹּר אֶת יוֹם צֵאתְךָ מֵאֶרֶץ
מִצָּרִים כָּל יְמֵי חַיֶּיךָ, יְמֵי
חַיֶּיךָ - הַיָּמִים, כָּל יְמֵי חַיֶּיךָ
- הַלַּיְלוֹת. וְחֻכָּמִים אֹמְרִים:
יְמֵי חַיֶּיךָ - הָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה, כָּל
יְמֵי חַיֶּיךָ - לְהָבִיא לִימּוֹת
הַמָּשִׁיחַ.

be recounted at night until Ben Zoma explained it: The verse says, 'That you may remember the day you left Egypt all the days of your life'. Why does it say 'all the days of your life' instead of simply 'the days of your life'? It must be that this extraneous word 'all' indicates the verse implies that the nights are included as well." But the other sages disagreed, interpreting the verse as follows: 'the days of your life' refers to the era of today, the extraneous word 'all' indicates we will be obligated to recount the Exodus even after the arrival of the Messiah.

WHAT IS THE COMMANDMENT, AND HOW DOES ONE FULFILL IT?

בָּרוּךְ הַמָּקוֹם, בָּרוּךְ הוּא.
בָּרוּךְ שֶׁנָּתַן תּוֹרָה לְעַמּוֹ
יִשְׂרָאֵל, בָּרוּךְ הוּא.

Blessed is the Omnipresent, He is blessed. Blessed is the One Who gave the Torah to his people Israel, He is blessed.

כְּנֶגֶד אַרְבָּעָה בָּנִים דִּבְרָה
תּוֹרָה. אֶחָד חָכָם, וְאֶחָד
רָשָׁע, וְאֶחָד תָּם, וְאֶחָד
שֶׁאֵינוֹ יוֹדֵעַ לִשְׁאֹל.

The Torah speaks of four sons: one who is wise, one who is wicked, one who is simple, and one who does not even know how to ask a question.

חָכָם - מָה הוּא אוֹמֵר? מַה
הָעֵדוּת וְהַחֻקִּים וְהַמִּשְׁפָּטִים
אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ

What does the wise one ask? He asks: "What are the statutes, decrees, and laws that The Eternal our God has commanded

אֶתְכֶם? וְאַף אֶתָּה אָמַר לוֹ
כָּה־לָכוֹת הַפֶּסַח: אֵין
מִפְטִירִין אַחֵר הַפֶּסַח
אֲפִיקוֹמָן.

רָשָׁע - מָה הוּא אוֹמֵר? מָה
הָעֲבֹדָה הַזֹּאת לָכֶם? לָכֶם -
וְלֹא לוֹ. וְלִפִּי שְׁהוֹצִיא אֶת
עַצְמוֹ מִן הַכָּלל כִּפָּר בְּעֶקֶר.
וְאַף אֶתָּה הִקְהֵה אֶת שְׁנֵי
וְאָמַר לוֹ: בַּעֲבוּר זֶה עָשָׂה יי
לִי בְּצֵאתִי מִמִּצְרָיִם. לִי -
וְלֹא לוֹ. אֵילּוּ הָיָה שֵׁם, לֹא
הָיָה נִגְאָל.

תָּם - מָה הוּא אוֹמֵר? מָה
זֹאת? וְאָמַרְתָּ אֵלָיו: בְּחֹזֶק
יָד הוֹצִיאָנוּ יי מִמִּצְרָיִם,
מִבֵּית עֲבָדִים.

וְשִׂיאֵינוּ יוֹדֵעַ לִשְׂאוֹל - אֶתָּה
פָּתַח לוֹ, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְהִגַּדְתָּ
לְבִנְךָ בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא לֵאמֹר,
בַּעֲבוּר זֶה עָשָׂה יי לִי
בְּצֵאתִי מִמִּצְרָיִם.

you?" You should relay to him all of the Passover laws and rituals, all the way up to the rule that one should not eat after he or she has partaken of the Paschal lamb as the Afikoman.

What does the wicked one ask? He asks: "What is this service to you?" The manner in which he says the word 'you' implies that he does not include himself; and because he removes himself from the rest of the group, he is a heretic at heart. To respond, you should forcefully retort him, citing the verse: "It is because of this that The Eternal did this for me when I left Egypt." The word 'me' should imply that he is not included — for if he had been there, he would not have been saved.

What does the simple son ask? He asks: "What is this?" You should cite him the verse, "With a strong hand The Eternal brought us out of Egypt, the house of slavery."

And for the one who does not even know how to ask a question, you should initiate the discussion, citing: "And you shall tell your son on that day, saying: it is because of this The Eternal did this for me when I left Egypt."

WHAT IS THE TIMEFRAME TO FULFILL THIS COMMANDMENT
OF RETELLING THE EXODUS?

יכול מראש חֹדֶשׁ, תִּלְמוֹד
לוֹמַר בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא, אִי בַּיּוֹם
הַהוּא יִכּוֹל מִבְּעוֹד יוֹם,
תִּלְמוֹד לוֹמַר בַּעֲבוּר זֶה -
בַּעֲבוּר זֶה לֹא אֲמַרְתִּי אֶלָּא
בְּשַׁעֲהַ שְׂיֵשׁ מַצָּה וּמָרוֹר
מִנְחִים לִפְנֵיךָ.

It is possible that one may believe we should recount the Exodus from the beginning of the month of Nissan, but the Torah teaches us otherwise; stating: "On that day". Even with this teaching, one might believe that he or she could start retelling the Exodus at any point during that day. However, the verse also states "because of this" — 'this' referring to the merit of eating matzah — thereby the verse teaches us that we may only fulfill the commandment of recounting the Exodus at the time when the matzah and bitter vegetables are laid out in front of you. Therefore, we may only fulfill our obligation at night, during the Seder when the matzah and marror are present; for that is the time when those commandments can be fulfilled.

THE RETELLING OF THE EXODUS BEGINS

מִתְחִלָּה עוֹבְדֵי עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה
הָיוּ אֲבוֹתֵינוּ, וְעַכְשָׁיו קִרְבָּנוּ

The story of the Exodus truly begins from when our ancestors worshipped false deities, even

הַמָּקוֹם לַעֲבֹדָתוֹ, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר:
וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶל כָּל הָעָם,
כֹּה אָמַר יי אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל:
בָּעֵבֶר הִנָּהָר יֵשְׁבוּ
אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם מֵעוֹלָם, תֶּרַח אֲבִי
אַבְרָהָם וְאֲבִי נָחוֹר, וַיַּעֲבֹדוּ
אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים. וְאַקַּח אֶת
אֲבִיכֶם אֶת אַבְרָהָם מֵעֵבֶר
הִנָּהָר וְאוֹלַךְ אוֹתוֹ בְּכָל
אֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן, וְאַרְבָּה אֶת זֶרְעוֹ
וְאֶתָּן לוֹ אֶת יִצְחָק, וְאֶתָּן
לְיִצְחָק אֶת יַעֲקֹב וְאֶת עֵשָׂו.
וְאֶתָּן לְעֵשָׂו אֶת הָר שֵׁעִיר
לְרֶשֶׁת אוֹתוֹ, וַיַּעֲקֹב וּבָנָיו
יָרְדוּ מִצְרָיִם.

though we have now been welcomed into the service of the Omnipresent. We know this because the verse says: "And Joshua spoke to the entire nation, 'So says The Eternal, the God of Israel: Our ancestors once dwelled on the other side of the river — Terach, the father of Abraham and Nachor — and they served other gods. But I took your father, Abraham, across that river, and led him through the entire land of Canaan; and I multiplied his offspring and gave him Isaac. And to Isaac I gave Jacob and Eisav. And to Eisav I gave Mount Seir for him as an inheritance, but Jacob and his sons I sent down to Egypt.'" From this we can infer that the Exodus was part of the Divine Plan even before we started worshipping The Eternal.

בָּרוּךְ שׁוֹמֵר הַבְּטָחָתוֹ
לְיִשְׂרָאֵל, בָּרוּךְ הוּא.
שֶׁהַקְּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא חָשַׁב
אֶת הַקֵּץ, לַעֲשׂוֹת כְּמָה
שֶׁאָמַר לְאַבְרָהָם אֲבִינוּ
בְּבְרִית בֵּין הַבְּתָרִים,
שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וַיֹּאמֶר לְאַבְרָם,

Blessed is He Who keeps His promises to Israel, He is blessed. For the Holy and Blessed One formulated the end of our slavery before it even began, in order to fulfill His Covenant of the Parts with Abraham; as the verse states: "And He said to Abram,¹ 'You shall surely know that your offspring will be strangers in a land that is not

יָדַע תִּדַּע כִּי גֵר יִהְיֶה זֶרַעְךָ
 בְּאֶרֶץ לֹא לָהֶם, וַעֲבָדוּם
 וְעָנּוּ אֹתָם אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת
 שָׁנָה. וְגַם אֶת הַגּוֹי אֲשֶׁר
 יַעֲבֹדוּ דָן אֶנְכִי וְאַחֲרֵי כֵן
 יֵצְאוּ בִּרְכָשׁ גָּדוֹל.

theirs, and I will enslave them and make them suffer for four hundred years. But I Myself shall pass judgement on the nation that enslaves you, and afterwards your offspring will leave with great wealth."

¹The verse cited here takes place prior to when God changed Abram's name to Abraham in Genesis 17:5.

Cover the matzah, lift your cup of wine, and declare the following:

וְהִיא שְׁעִמָּדָה לְאַבוֹתֵינוּ
 וְלָנוּ! שְׁלֹא אֶחָד בְּלִבָּד עָמַד
 עָלֵינוּ לְכַלּוֹתֵנוּ, אֲלֹא שְׁבִכָּל
 דּוֹר וָדוֹר עוֹמְדִים עָלֵינוּ
 לְכַלּוֹתֵנוּ, וְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ
 הוּא מַצִּילֵנוּ מִיָּדָם.

This is what our forefathers relied upon, and what we still rely upon: For not just this one enemy alone has risen against us to annihilate us, but in every generation they rise against us to annihilate us — but the Holy and Blessed One saves us from their hands!

The cup of wine is put back down and the matzah is again uncovered.

At this point, the recounting of the Exodus proceeds in the style of Talmudical exegesis. Passages or verses are cited, and then each phrase in each verse is analyzed separately to determine what additional insights can be gained from a more critical reading of the text. Participants are encouraged to formulate their own interpretations, and this is an ideal time during the Seder to incorporate additional ideas or themes that foster a connection to the traditional material.

The following verses do not come from the story of the Exodus in the Torah. Rather, these verses are actually those cited when one brings

their first fruits to the Holy Temple, a commandment called *bikkurim*. Why is it, then, that we use this passage as the focal point of the Haggadah? Would it not make more sense to simply read the straight text of the Torah, the passages that detail the events from when Pharaoh enslaved the Jews until after the Jewish people sang praises after the splitting of the Red Sea?

The answer to this question is that it is not merely enough to read the passages in the Torah, because reading is a passive activity that involves events of the past. The Haggadah is supposed to invoke a living, breathing sense of freedom — the aim is not to remember the past but to grapple with the text and try to find how it applies to our daily lives. The Haggadah thus opts to use this cite-and-expound methodology: it does not ask us to merely recall history, but rather to allow the Exodus to forge our future.

צֵא וְלָמַד מֶה בִּקְשׁ לָבוֹן
הָאֲרָמִי לַעֲשׂוֹת לִיעֲקֹב
אָבִינוּ. שְׁפָרְעָה לֹא גִזַּר
אֶלָּא עַל הַזְּכָרִים וְלָבוֹן בִּקְשׁ
לַעֲקֹר אֶת הַכֹּל, שְׁנֵאמַר:
אֲרָמִי אֲבִד אָבִי, וַיֵּרֶד
מִצְרַיִמָּה וַיֵּגֶר שָׁם בְּמִתִּי
מְעַט, וַיְהִי שָׁם לְגוֹי גָּדוֹל,
עֲצוּם וָרֹב.

We know that God has saved us time and again — for example, go out and learn for yourself what Lavan the Aramean wanted to do to our father Jacob. Pharaoh had issued a decree against only the male children, but Lavan wanted to uproot everything — as the verse states: "The Aramean wished to obliterate my father; but he [my father] descended to Egypt and sojourned there, few in number; and there he became a great nation that was mighty and numerous."

"וַיֵּרֶד מִצְרַיִמָּה" - אָנוּס עַל
פִּי הַדְּבָר.

"But he [my father] descended to Egypt" — he was forced to

descend because of Divine Providence.

"וַיָּגֵר שָׁם" - מְלִמָּד שֶׁלֹּא
יָרַד יַעֲקֹב אֲבִינוּ לְהַשְׁתַּקֵּעַ
בְּמִצְרַיִם אֲלָא לְגֹר שָׁם,
שֶׁנֶּאֱמָר: וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֶל פַּרְעֹה,
לְגֹר בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן, כִּי אֵין
מְרֻעָה לְצֹאן אֲשֶׁר לַעֲבָדֶיךָ,
כִּי כָבֵד הָרָעַב בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן.
וְעַתָּה יֵשְׁבוּ נָא עֲבָדֶיךָ
בְּאֶרֶץ גִּשְׁשׁוֹן.

"And he sojourned there" — this teaches us that our patriarch Jacob did not descend to Egypt to settle there, but only to temporarily reside there; as this verse indicates: "And they said to Pharaoh, we have come to sojourn here in this land, because there is no pasture for your servants' flocks, since the famine in the land of Canaan is so severe. So please now let us your servants dwell in the land of Goshen." They came only because of hunger, not because of a desire to live in the land of Egypt.

"בְּמִתִּי מְעוֹט" - כְּמָה
שֶׁנֶּאֱמָר: בְּשִׁבְעִים נֶפֶשׁ
יָרְדוּ אֲבוֹתֶיךָ מִצְרַיִם,
וְעַתָּה שְׂמֵךְ יי אֱלֹהֶיךָ
כְּכֹכְבֵי הַשָּׁמַיִם לָרֹב.

"Few in number" — this is supported by another verse, which states: "Your seventy ancestors went down to Egypt, and now The Eternal your God has made you as numerous as the stars of heaven."

"וַיְהִי שָׁם לְגוֹי" - מְלִמָּד
שֶׁהָיוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מְצִינִים שָׁם.

"And there he became a nation" — this teaches us that Israel remained distinctive in the land of Egypt.

"גָּדוֹל, עֲצוֹם" - כְּמָה
שֶׁנֶּאֱמָר: וּבָנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל פָּרוּ

"Great, mighty" — this is supported by another verse, which states: "And the children of Israel were fruitful, increased

וַיִּשְׁרְצוּ וַיִּרְבוּ וַיַּעֲצְמוּ בְּמֵאֲדָ
מֵאֲדָ, וַתִּמָּלֵא הָאָרֶץ אֹתָם.

abundantly, multiplied, and became very, very mighty; and the land became filled with them."

"וַרְבַּ" - כְּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר:
רַבָּה כְּצֶמַח הַשָּׂדֶה
נִתְתִּיךָ, וַתִּרְבִּי וַתִּגְדְּלִי
וַתִּבְאֵי בַעֲדֵי עֲדִיִּים, שְׂדֵים
נִכְנֹו וּשְׂעָרְךָ צִמָּח, וְאַף
עֹרֹם וְעֵרִיָּה. וְאָעֵבֶר עָלֶיךָ
וְאֶרְאֶךָ מִתְבּוֹסֶסֶת בְּדַמֶּיךָ,
וְאָמַר לְךָ בְּדַמֶּיךָ חַיִּי, וְאָמַר
לְךָ בְּדַמֶּיךָ חַיִּי.

"And numerous" — this is an allusion to another verse: "I have granted you to be like a plethora of plants in the field, and you increased and grew and became very beautiful; your bosom fashioned and your hair grown long, but you were naked and bare. So I passed over you and saw you wallowing in your collective blood, and I said to you 'By your blood you shall live!' and [again] I said to you 'By your blood you shall live!'" In this verse, the word for "plethora" uses the same Hebrew etymology as our verse does for the word "numerous". This cited verse is an allusion to the commandment of circumcision, as the expression "By your blood you shall live" is recited as part of the ceremony. It is an expression of how even though we sometimes suffer pain, our covenant with The Eternal is forever; He shall always ensure that we grow and thrive.

וַיִּרְעוּ אֹתָנוּ הַמִּצְרִים
וַיַּעֲנוּנוּ, וַיִּתְּנוּ עָלֵינוּ עֲבֹדָה

The Egyptians treated us badly and made us suffer, and they

קָשָׁה. gave us hard work.

"וַיֵּרְעוּ אֹתָנוּ הַמִּצְרִים" -
כָּמָה שָׁנְאָמָר: הִבָּה
נִתְחַכְמָה לוֹ כֵּן יִרְבֶּה, וְהָיָה
כִּי תִקְרָאנָה מִלְחָמָה וְנוֹסִף
גַּם הוּא עַל שִׁנְאֵינוּ וְנִלְחַם
בָּנוּ, וְעָלָה מִן הָאָרֶץ.

"The Egyptians treated us badly," as the story indicates: "Come, let us outwit the people lest they multiply; and if war breaks out, they will join our enemies and fight against us to leave the land." Their paranoia led them to believe we would rise against them before they ever even began to persecute us, thus they treated us with the disdain from the start.

"וַיַּעֲנוּנוּ" - כָּמָה שָׁנְאָמָר:
וַיִּשְׁיִמוּ עָלֵינוּ שָׂרֵי מִסִּים
לְמַעַן עֲנֹתוּ בְּסִבְלָתָם. וַיִּבְנוּ
עָרֵי מִסְכָּנוֹת לְפָרְעֹה. אֶת
פָּתָם וְאֶת רַעְמִסִּים.

"And they made us suffer," as the story indicates: "They set taskmasters over them to make them suffer with their burdens, and they built storage cities for Pharaoh: Pithom and Ramses."

"וַיִּתְּנוּ עָלֵינוּ עֲבֹדָה קָשָׁה" -
כָּמָה שָׁנְאָמָר: וַיַּעֲבֹדוּ
מִצְרַיִם אֶת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל
בְּפָרֶךְ.

"And they gave us hard work," as the story indicates: "And the Egyptians made us work in harsh conditions."

וַנִּצְעַק אֶל יְיָ אֱלֹהֵי אֲבוֹתֵינוּ,
וַיִּשְׁמַע יְיָ אֶת קוֹלֵנוּ, וַיִּרְא
אֶת עַנְיֵינוּ וְאֶת עֲמָלֵנוּ וְאֶת
לַחֲצֵנוּ.

The passage continues: "And we cried out to The Eternal, the God of our ancestors, and The Eternal heard our voice and saw our suffering, our labor and our oppression."

"וַנִּצְעַק אֶל יְיָ אֱלֹהֵי
אֲבוֹתֵינוּ" - כִּמָּה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר:
וַיְהִי בַיָּמִים הָרַבִּים הָהֵם
וַיָּמָת מֶלֶךְ מִצְרַיִם, וַיֹּאנְחוּ
בְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מִן הָעֲבֹדָה
וַיִּזְעֻקוּ, וַתַּעַל שְׁוַעְתָּם אֶל
הָאֱלֹהִים מִן הָעֲבֹדָה.

"וַיִּשְׁמַע יְיָ אֶת קוֹלֵנוּ" - כִּמָּה
שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וַיִּשְׁמַע אֱלֹהִים
אֶת נַאֲקָתָם, וַיִּזְכּוֹר אֱלֹהִים
אֶת בְּרִיתוֹ אֶת אַבְרָהָם,
אֶת יִצְחָק וְאֶת יַעֲקֹב.

"וַיֵּרָא אֶת עֲנִיֵּנוּ" - זוֹ
פְּרִישׁוֹת דֶּרֶךְ אֶרֶץ, כִּמָּה
שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וַיֵּרָא אֱלֹהִים אֶת
בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיֵּדַע אֱלֹהִים.

"וְאֵת עֲמָלָנוּ" - אֵלּוּ הַבָּנִים.
כִּמָּה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: כָּל הַבֶּן
הַיָּלֹד הַיָּאֲרָה תִשְׁלִיכֻהוּ
וְכָל הַבַּת תְּחִיּוֹן.

"And we cried out to The
Eternal, the God of our
ancestors," as the story
indicates: "During that long
period, the king of Egypt died;
and the children of Israel
moaned and wailed under their
servitude; and from their
slavery, their supplications
ascended to God."

"And The Eternal heard our
voice," as the story indicates:
"And God heard their agony, and
God remembered His covenant
with Abraham, Isaac and Jacob."

"And he saw our suffering" —
this refers to the separation of
husband and wife, as the story
alludes: "And God saw the
children of Israel, and it was
known to God." The unusual term
"it was known" is an allusion to
this separation, employing the
common biblical euphemism for
cohabitation.

"And our labor" — the labor was
overwhelming because Pharaoh
had decreed the death of all
Jewish sons: "Every boy that is
born, you shall throw into the
river; but every girl you may
keep alive."

"וְאֵת לַחֲצֵנוּ" - זֶה הַדִּחָק,
כִּמָּה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְגַם רָאִיתִי
אֶת הַלַּחֲץ אֲשֶׁר מִצְרַיִם
לַחֲצִים אֹתָם.

"And our oppression" — this refers to the pressure placed upon them to complete their tasks, as the verse states: "I have also seen the oppression with which the Egyptians oppress them."

וַיּוֹצֵאֵנוּ יי מִמִּצְרַיִם בְּיָד
חֲזָקָה וּבְזֵרַע נְטוּיָה, וּבְמֹרָא
גָּדֹל, וּבְאֹתוֹת וּבְמִפְתִּים.

The passage continues: "The Eternal took us out of Egypt with a strong hand and an outstretched arm, and with a great manifestation, signs, and wonders."

"וַיּוֹצֵאֵנוּ יי מִמִּצְרַיִם" - לֹא
עַל יְדֵי מַלְאָךְ, וְלֹא עַל יְדֵי
שָׂרָף, וְלֹא עַל יְדֵי שְׁלִיחַ,
אֲלָא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא
בְּכְבוֹדוֹ וּבְעֶצְמוֹ, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר:
וְעָבַרְתִּי בָאָרֶץ מִצְרַיִם
בְּלִילָה הַזֶּה, וְהִכֵּיתִי כָל
בְּכוֹר בָּאָרֶץ מִצְרַיִם מֵאָדָם
וְעַד בְּהֵמָה, וּבְכָל אֱלֹהֵי
מִצְרַיִם אֶעֱשֶׂה שְׁפָטִים. אֲנִי
יי.

"The Eternal took us out of Egypt" — not through an angel, not through a seraph, and not through a messenger; rather the Holy and Blessed One with His honor and by Himself; as the verse states: "On that night I will pass through the land of Egypt, and I will strike every first-born in the land of Egypt, from man to beast, and I will carry out judgments against all the gods of Egypt; I, The Eternal." This is further expounded in the following tangent:

"וְעָבַרְתִּי בָאָרֶץ מִצְרַיִם
בְּלִילָה הַזֶּה" - אֲנִי וְלֹא
מַלְאָךְ.

"I will pass through the land of Egypt" — I, and not an angel.

"וְהִכֵּיתִי כָּל בְּכוֹר בְּאֶרֶץ
מִצְרַיִם" - אֲנִי וְלֹא שֶׁרָף.

"And I will strike every first-born
in the land of Egypt" — I, and not
a seraph.

"וּבְכָל אֱלֹהֵי מִצְרַיִם אֶעֱשֶׂה
שְׁפָטִים" - אֲנִי וְלֹא הַשְּׁלִיחַ.

"And I will carry out judgments
against all the gods of Egypt" — I,
and not a messenger.

"אֲנִי יְיָ" - אֲנִי הוּא וְלֹא
אַחֵר.

"I, The Eternal" — I alone, and no
other!

"בְּיָד חֲזָקָה" - זֶה הַדָּבָר,
כִּמָּה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: הִנֵּה יָד יְיָ
הוֹיָה בְּמִקְנֶךָ אֲשֶׁר בַּשָּׂדֶה,
בַּסּוּסִים, בַּחֲמֹרִים, בַּגְּמִלִים,
בַּבָּקָר וּבַצֹּאן, דָּבָר כָּבֵד
מְאֹד.

Returning to the original
passage, we shall continue
expounding the earlier verse:
"With a strong hand" — this
refers to the plague of
pestilence, as the verse states:
"Behold, the hand of The Eternal
will be upon your livestock in the
field, upon the horses, the
donkeys, the camels, the herds
and the flocks, a very severe
pestilence." The pestilence was
so severe that it could only have
been from the hand of The
Eternal.

וּבְזֵרַע נְטוּיָה - זֶה הַחֶרֶב,
כִּמָּה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וַחֲרָבוֹ
שְׁלוּפָה בְּיָדוֹ, נְטוּיָה עַל
יְרוּשָׁלַיִם.

"And with an outstretched arm"
— this alludes to the sword, as
illuminated by the following
verse about King David: "His
sword was drawn in his hand,
outstretched over Jerusalem."
This is a reference to the slaying
of the first-born, who seemed as
though they had been slain by
the sword.

"וּבְמַרְא גָדֹל" - זוּ גְלוּי
 שְׂכִינָה, כָּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: אוּ
 הַנִּסָּה אֱלֹהִים לְבֹא לְקַחַת
 לוֹ גּוֹי מִקֶּרֶב גּוֹי בְּמִסַּת
 בָּאֲתֹת וּבְמוֹפְתִים,
 וּבְמִלְחָמָה וּבִיד חֲזָקָה
 וּבִזְרוּעַ נְטוּיָה, וּבְמוֹרָאִים
 גְּדֹלִים, כָּכֹל אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה
 לָכֶם יְיָ אֱלֹהֵיכֶם בְּמִצְרַיִם
 לְעֵינֶיךָ.

"And with a great manifestation," this refers to the revelation of the Divine Presence, as is referenced in the verse: "Is there any other god that could ever try to take for himself a nation from the midst of another nation, with spectacles, signs and wonders; with war, a strong hand and an outstretched arm; and with great manifestations, like everything that The Eternal your God did for you in Egypt before your very eyes?"

"וּבְאֲתֹת" - זֶה הַמָּטָה,
 כָּמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְאֵת הַמָּטָה
 הַזֶּה תִּקַּח בְּיָדְךָ, אֲשֶׁר
 תַּעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ אֶת הָאֲתֹת.

"And with signs" — this refers to the staff of Moses, as the verse indicates when God commands him: "And this staff, take it in your hand; and with it you shall perform the signs."

It is customary to spill a drop of wine from one's cup while reciting each of the following bolded phrases. One should not drink the wine that is removed; instead it should be discarded at the conclusion of Maggid. Although some may be accustomed to using one's finger to remove the wine, this should be avoided. Instead, wine should be spilled directly from the cup, preferably onto a designated dish rather than one's plate. Alternatively, one can dip a napkin or cloth to soak up some of the wine from the cup instead.

The reason for this custom is because the spilled wine is supposed to symbolize the blood of the Egyptians. Even though they enslaved us, they were still human beings. We respect their humanity enough to acknowledge that their deaths are worthy of limiting our celebration

somehow, even if it is only represented by us reducing the amount of wine we consume by a few drops.

It is for this reason that one should avoid using their finger to remove the wine. Given the symbolism, we do not want to convey the notion that we accept the idea that the blood of the Egyptians is on our hands. The Egyptians were punished for their own sins by God, and not because we did them evil. Our only intent is to limit our rejoicing — even if only by a tiny iota — and not to suggest we actively sought the Egyptians' death as the key means to achieve our freedom.

וּבְמִפְתִּים - זֶה הַדָּם, כָּמָה
שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְנִתְּתִי מוֹפְתִים
בַּשָּׁמַיִם וּבָאָרֶץ: "And wonders" — this refers to
the blood, as the following verse
alludes to through the
juxtaposition of the words: "And
I shall show wonders in heaven
and on earth:

דָּם, blood,

וְאֵשׁ, and fire,

וְתִימָרוֹת עָשָׁן. and pillars of smoke."

דָּבָר אַחֵר: בִּיד חֲזָקָה -
שְׁתֵּים, וּבְזֶרַע נְטוּיָה -
שְׁתֵּים, וּבְמָרָא גָדֹל -
שְׁתֵּים, וּבְאֵתוֹת - שְׁתֵּים,
וּבְמִפְתִּים - שְׁתֵּים. Another explanation is that this
verse refers to the total number
of plagues, a count of ten:
"Strong hand" indicates two
plagues, since the human body
has two hands; "Outstretched
arm" corresponds to another
two, for the same reason; "Great
manifestation," another two,
since 'manifestation' is singular
and therefore a 'great
manifestation' implies one more
than that; "Signs," another two,

because two is the smallest plural; and "Wonders," another two, for the same reason.

אֵלֹהֵי עֲשׂוֹר מַכּוֹת שֶׁהֵבִיא
הַקְדּוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא עַל
הַמִּצְרִים בְּמִצְרַיִם, וְאֵלֹהֵי הֵן:

And thus the verse refers to these ten plagues which the Holy and Blessed One brought upon the citizens of Egypt, enumerated as follows:

דָּם, blood,

צַפְרִידֵּעַ, frogs,

כִּנִּים, lice,

עָרֹב, wild animals,

דָּבָר, pestilence,

שָׁחִין, boils,

בָּרָד, meteors,¹

אַרְבֶּה, locusts,

חֹשֶׁךְ, darkness,

מַכַּת בְּכוֹרוֹת. slaying of the first-born.

¹The seventh plague is frequently mistranslated as 'hail', but the verses in Exodus 9:18-25 indicate that it was a singularly unique phenomenon: that it had never happened before and never will again; that it was fire raining from the sky, that it broke the trees and killed animals and people that were struck. In context, it seems that the simplest explanation is that it was a plague of meteors.

רַבִּי יְהוּדָה הָיָה נוֹתֵן בָּהֶם Rabbi Yehudah gave them a
סִמְנִים: mnemonic:

דֵּצַח, *detzach*,

עַדָּשׁ, *adash*,

בְּאַחַב, *b'echav*.

רַבִּי יוֹסִי הַגָּלִילִי אוֹמֵר: מִנֵּין
אַתָּה אוֹמֵר שְׁלֹקוּ הַמִּצְרִים
בַּמִּצְרִים עָשׂוּ מַכּוֹת וְעַל
הֵם לָקוּ חֲמִשִּׁים מַכּוֹת?
בַּמִּצְרִים מָה הוּא אוֹמֵר?
וַיֹּאמְרוּ הַחֲרָטָמִים אֶל
פַּרְעֹה: אֲצַבֵּעַ אֱלֹהִים הוּא,
וְעַל הֵם מָה הוּא אוֹמֵר?
וַיֹּרֶא יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת הַיָּד
הַגְּדֹלָה אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה יי
בַּמִּצְרִים, וַיִּירָאוּ הָעָם אֶת
יי, וַיֹּאמְרֵם בְּיַי וּבַמִּשָּׁה
עָבְדוּ. כִּמָּה לָקוּ בְּאֲצַבָּע?
עָשׂוּ מַכּוֹת. אָמור מֵעַתָּה:
בַּמִּצְרִים לָקוּ עָשׂוּ מַכּוֹת
וְעַל הֵם לָקוּ חֲמִשִּׁים
מַכּוֹת.

The last verse we recited hinted to the fact that there were ten plagues. Rabbi Yossi from the Gallilee asked: How do you know that if the Egyptians were stricken by ten plagues in Egypt, then they were struck by fifty plagues at the sea? Because of the following proof:

While in Egypt, the verse states: "The magicians said to Pharaoh: 'This is the finger of God.'" But at the sea, the verse states: "Israel saw the great hand that The Eternal excercised against Egypt; and the people were in awe of The Eternal, and they believed in The Eternal and in His servant Moses." Based on these verses, how often were they struck by 'the finger'? Ten plagues. From this you must conclude at the sea they were smitten five times more, for a hand has five fingers; in other words, that if in Egypt they were struck by ten plagues, then at

the sea they must have been struck with fifty plagues.

רַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר אוֹמֵר: מִנֵּין
שָׁפַל מַכָּה וּמַכָּה שֶׁהֵבִיא
הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא עַל
הַמִּצְרִים בְּמִצְרַיִם הִיתָה
שֶׁל אַרְבַּע מַכּוֹת? שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר:
יִשְׁלַח בָּם חֲרוֹן אַפּוֹ, עֲבָרָה
וְזַעַם וְצָרָה, מְשִׁלַּחַת
מַלְאֲכֵי רָעִים. עֲבָרָה -
אַחַת, וְזַעַם - שְׁתֵּי, וְצָרָה
- שְׁלֹשׁ, מְשִׁלַּחַת מַלְאֲכֵי
רָעִים - אַרְבַּע. אָמור
מֵעַתָּה: בְּמִצְרַיִם לָקוּ
אַרְבָּעִים מַכּוֹת וְעַל הַיָּם
לָקוּ מֵאַתֵּיּם מַכּוֹת.

While in the context of discussing how many plagues God brought upon Egypt, Rabbi Eliezer offered the following insight: How do we know that each individual plague which the Holy and Blessed One brought upon the citizens of Egypt consisted of four plagues?

We can infer it from this verse: "He sent against them His fierce anger, fury, and indignation, and trouble, a discharge of messengers of evil": 'Fury' is one, 'Indignation' is two, 'Trouble' is three, 'Discharge of messengers of evil' is four. Therefore you must now say that in Egypt they were actually struck by forty plagues; so at the sea they must have been stricken by two hundred plagues.

רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא אוֹמֵר: מִנֵּין
שָׁפַל מַכָּה וּמַכָּה שֶׁהֵבִיא
הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא עַל
הַמִּצְרִים בְּמִצְרַיִם הִיתָה
שֶׁל חֲמִשׁ מַכּוֹת? שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר:
יִשְׁלַח בָּם חֲרוֹן אַפּוֹ, עֲבָרָה
וְזַעַם וְצָרָה, מְשִׁלַּחַת

However, Rabbi Akiva disagreed with Rabbi Eliezer, reframing the count as follows: How do we know that each individual plague which the Holy and Blessed One brought upon the citizens of Egypt consisted of five plagues (rather than four)?

מִלֵּאכֵי רָעִים. חֲרוֹן אַפּוֹ -
 אַחַת, עֲבָרָה - שְׂתִימָה, וְזַעַם
 - שָׁלֵשׁ, וְצָרָה - אַרְבַּע,
 מִשְׁלַחַת מִלֵּאכֵי רָעִים -
 חֲמִשָּׁה. אָמור מֵעַתָּה:
 בְּמִצְרַיִם לָקוּ חֲמִשִּׁים מַכּוֹת
 וְעַל הַיָּם לָקוּ חֲמִשִּׁים
 וּמֵאֲתַיִם מַכּוֹת.

We can infer it from this same verse: "He sent against them His fierce anger, fury, and indignation, and trouble, a discharge of messengers of evil": Unlike Rabbi Eliezer's interpretation, 'fierce anger' should be counted as one; then 'Fury' is two, 'Indignation' is three, 'Trouble' is four, and 'Discharge of messengers of evil' is five. Therefore you must now say that in Egypt they were actually struck by fifty plagues; so at the sea they must have been stricken by two hundred and fifty plagues.

DAYENU

There are two distinct emotional components of the Seder: one is to feel as though one has been a part of the Exodus, and the other is to praise Hashem for all that He has done for us. This first component is Maggid, the second is Hallel. However, it is essential to understand that these two components are intrinsically linked with each other; therefore the Haggadah maintains a bridge between Maggid and Hallel: we express our gratitude to what the Exodus means for us, and then we continue to praise Him.

כַּמָּה מַעֲלֹת טוֹבוֹת לַמָּקוֹם
 עָלֵינוּ!

How many levels of goodness
 has the Omnipresent bestowed
 us!

אֱלֹהֵינוּ הוֹצִיאָנוּ מִמִּצְרַיִם
וְלֹא עָשָׂה בָּהֶם שְׁפָטִים,
דִּיּוּנוֹ. If He had brought us out from
Egypt, but had not carried out
judgments against them, it
would have been enough!

אֱלֹהֵינוּ עָשָׂה בָּהֶם שְׁפָטִים,
וְלֹא עָשָׂה בְּאֱלֹהֵיהֶם, דִּיּוּנוֹ. If He had carried out judgments
against them, but not against
their idols, it would have been
enough!

אֱלֹהֵינוּ עָשָׂה בְּאֱלֹהֵיהֶם,
וְלֹא הָרַג אֶת בְּכוֹרֵיהֶם,
דִּיּוּנוֹ. If He had destroyed their idols,
but had not slain their first-born,
it would have been enough!

אֱלֹהֵינוּ הָרַג אֶת בְּכוֹרֵיהֶם,
וְלֹא נָתַן לָנוּ אֶת מָמוֹנָם,
דִּיּוּנוֹ. If He had slain their first-born,
but had not given us their
wealth, it would have been
enough!

אֱלֹהֵינוּ נָתַן לָנוּ אֶת מָמוֹנָם,
וְלֹא קָרַע לָנוּ אֶת הַיָּם,
דִּיּוּנוֹ. If He had given us their wealth,
but had not split the sea for us, it
would have been enough!

אֱלֹהֵינוּ קָרַע לָנוּ אֶת הַיָּם
וְלֹא הֶעֱבִירָנוּ בְּתוֹכוֹ
בַּחֲרָבָה, דִּיּוּנוֹ. If He had split the sea for us, but
had not taken us through it on
dry land, it would have been
enough!

אֱלֹהֵינוּ הֶעֱבִירָנוּ בְּתוֹכוֹ
בַּחֲרָבָה
וְלֹא שָׁקַע צָרָנוּ בְּתוֹכוֹ,
דִּיּוּנוֹ. If He had taken us through the
sea on dry land, but had not
drowned our oppressors in it, it
would have been enough!

אֱלֹהֵינוּ שָׁקַע צָרָנוּ בְּתוֹכוֹ
וְלֹא סִפֵּק צָרָכָנוּ בַּמִּדְבָּר. If He had drowned our
oppressors in it, but had not
supplied our needs in the desert

אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה, דִּיּינוּ.

for forty years, it would have been enough!

אֱלֹהֵי סֶפֶק צָרְכֵּנוּ בַּמִּדְבָּר
אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה
וְלֹא הָאֲכִילָנוּ אֶת הַמָּן,
דִּיּינוּ.

If He had supplied our needs in the desert for forty years, but had not fed us the manna, it would have been enough!

אֱלֹהֵי הָאֲכִילָנוּ אֶת הַמָּן,
וְלֹא נָתַן לָנוּ אֶת הַשַּׁבָּת,
דִּיּינוּ.

If He had fed us the manna, but had not given us the Sabbath, it would have been enough!

אֱלֹהֵי נָתַן לָנוּ אֶת הַשַּׁבָּת,
וְלֹא קָרַבְנוּ לִפְנֵי הַר סִינַי,
דִּיּינוּ.

If He had given us the Sabbath, but had not brought us before Mount Sinai, it would have been enough!

אֱלֹהֵי קָרַבְנוּ לִפְנֵי הַר סִינַי,
וְלֹא נָתַן לָנוּ אֶת הַתּוֹרָה,
דִּיּינוּ.

If He had brought us before Mount Sinai, but had not given us the Torah, it would have been enough!

אֱלֹהֵי נָתַן לָנוּ אֶת הַתּוֹרָה
וְלֹא הִכְנִיסָנוּ לְאֶרֶץ
יִשְׂרָאֵל, דִּיּינוּ.

If He had given us the Torah, but had not brought us into the land of Israel, it would have been enough!

אֱלֹהֵי הִכְנִיסָנוּ לְאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל
וְלֹא בָנָה לָנוּ אֶת בֵּית
הַבְּחִירָה, דִּיּינוּ.

If He had brought us into the land of Israel, but had not built for us the Chosen House, the Holy Temple — it would have been enough!

עַל אַחַת, כַּמָּה וְכַמָּה, טוֹבָה
כְּפוּלָה וּמִכְפָּלָת לַמָּקוֹם
עָלֵינוּ: שֶׁהוֹצִיאָנוּ מִמִּצְרַיִם,

Thus how much more so should we be grateful for the doubled and redoubled good that the Omnipresent has placed upon

וַעֲשֶׂה בָּהֶם שְׁפָטִים, וַעֲשֶׂה
בְּאֱלֹהֵיהֶם, וְהָרַג אֶת
בְּכוֹרֵיהֶם, וְנָתַן לָנוּ אֶת
מַמּוֹנָם, וְקָרַע לָנוּ אֶת הַיָּם,
וְהַעֲבִירָנוּ בְּתוֹכוֹ בַּחֲרָבָה,
וְשָׁקַע צָרָנוּ בְּתוֹכוֹ, וְסָפַק
צָרָכָנוּ בַּמִּדְבָּר אֲרֻבַּעִים
שָׁנָה, וְהֶאֱכִילָנוּ אֶת הָמָן,
וְנָתַן לָנוּ אֶת הַשַּׁבָּת, וְקִרְבָּנוּ
לִפְנֵי הָרַם סִינִי, וְנָתַן לָנוּ אֶת
הַתּוֹרָה, וְהַכְנִיסָנוּ לָאָרֶץ
יִשְׂרָאֵל, וּבָנָה לָנוּ אֶת בֵּית
הַבְּחִירָה לְכַפֵּר עַל כָּל
עֲוֹנוֹתֵינוּ.

us; for He brought us out of Egypt, and carried out judgments against them and their idols, and killed their first-born, and gave us their wealth, and split the sea for us, and took us through it on dry land, and drowned our tormentors in it, and fulfilled our needs in the desert for forty years, and fed us the manna, and gave us the Sabbath, and brought us before Mount Sinai, and gave us the Torah, and brought us into the land of Israel, and built for us the Chosen House, the Holy Temple, to atone for all our sins.

THE CORE COMMANDMENT TO RETELL THE EXODUS

רַבֵּן גַּמְלִיאֵל הָיָה אוֹמֵר: כָּל
שֶׁלֹּא אָמַר שְׁלֹשָׁה דְּבָרִים
אֵלּוּ בַּפֶּסַח, לֹא יֵצֵא יָדָיו
חוּבָתוֹ, וְאֵלּוּ הֵן: פֶּסַח,
מַצָּה, וּמָרֹר.

Rabbi Gamliel would say: Whoever does not discuss three things on Passover has not fulfilled their obligation to retell the Exodus; these three things are the Paschal Lamb, the Matzah, and the Bitter Vegetables.

One should deliberately not point out the Zeroah on the seder plate while reciting the next paragraph, as it not an actual Paschal Lamb:

פֶּסַח שֶׁהָיוּ אֲבוֹתֵינוּ
אוֹכְלִים בְּזֶמֶן שְׁבִית
הַמִּקְדָּשׁ הָיָה קָיָם, עַל שׁוּם
מָה? עַל שׁוּם שֶׁפֶּסַח
הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא עַל בִּתְּי
אֲבוֹתֵינוּ בְּמִצְרַיִם, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר:
וַאֲמַרְתֶּם זָבַח פֶּסַח הוּא
לִי, אֲשֶׁר פֶּסַח עַל בִּתְּי בְּנֵי
יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּמִצְרַיִם בְּנִגְפוֹ אֶת
מִצְרַיִם, וְאֶת בִּתְּיֵנוּ הֲצִיל,
וַיִּקַּד הָעָם וַיִּשְׁתַּחֲווּ.

The Paschal Lamb, which our ancestors ate during the time of the Holy Temple, what does it signify? It is because the Holy and Blessed One passed over our fathers' houses in Egypt, as the verse states: "You shall say, 'It is a Passover-offering to The Eternal, because He passed over the houses of the children of Israel in Egypt when He plagued the Egyptians, but for our houses, He saved them.' And the people bowed and prostrated themselves."

Identify the matzah to all those present and recite the following:

מַצָּה זוֹ שֶׁאֲנוּ אוֹכְלִים, עַל
שׁוּם מָה? עַל שׁוּם שֶׁלֹּא
הִסְפִּיק בִּצְקָם שֶׁל אֲבוֹתֵינוּ
לְהַחֲמִיץ עַד שֶׁנִּגְלָה עֲלֵיהֶם
מֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים,
הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא, וּגְאָלָם,
שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וַיֹּאפּוּ אֶת הַבֶּצֶק
אֲשֶׁר הוֹצִיאוּ מִמִּצְרַיִם עֲגֹת
מִצּוֹת, כִּי לֹא חָמֵץ, כִּי
גִרְשׁוֹ מִמִּצְרַיִם וְלֹא יָכְלוּ

This matzah that we eat — what does it signify? It is because the dough of our ancestors did not have time to rise before the King of Emperors, the Holy and Blessed One, revealed Himself and redeemed them; as the verse states: "They baked the dough that they brought out of Egypt into cakes of matzah, that were not leavened, because they had been expelled out of Egypt and could not hesitate, and they had also not prepared any other provisions."

לְהִתְמַהֵּמָה, וְגַם צֹדָה לֹא
עָשׂוּ לָהֶם.

Identify the bitter vegetables to all those present and recite the following:

מָרֹר זֶה שְׂאֲנוּ אוֹכְלִים, עַל
שׁוֹם מָה? עַל שׁוֹם שְׁמִירוֹ
הַמִּצְרִים אֶת חַיֵּי אֲבוֹתֵינוּ
בַּמִּצְרִים, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וַיִּמְרֹ
אֶת חַיֵּיהֶם בַּעֲבֹדָה קָשָׁה,
בַּחֹמֶר וּבַלִּבְנִים וּבְכָל עֲבֹדָה
בַּשָּׂדֶה אֶת כָּל עֲבֹדָתָם
אֲשֶׁר עָבְדוּ בָהֶם בַּפֶּךְ.

These bitter vegetables that we eat — what do they signify? It is because the Egyptians embittered our ancestors' lives in Egypt, as the verse states: "And they embittered their lives with hard work; with mortar, bricks, and all the agricultural labor — all of their labor was served under harsh conditions."

בְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר חַיֵּב אָדָם
לִרְאוֹת אֶת עַצְמוֹ כְּאִלּוּ
הוּא יָצָא מִמִּצְרַיִם,
שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְהִגַּדְתָּ לְבִנְךָ בַּיּוֹם
הַהוּא לֵאמֹר, בַּעֲבוּר זֶה
עָשָׂה יי לִי בְּצֵאתִי
מִמִּצְרַיִם. לֹא אֶת אֲבוֹתֵינוּ
בְּלֶבֶד גָּאֵל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ
הוּא, אֲלֵא אֶף אוֹתָנוּ גָּאֵל
עִמָּהֶם, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: וְאוֹתָנוּ
הוֹצִיא מִשָּׁם, לְמַעַן הָבִיא

In every generation, a person is obligated to see himself as if he had left Egypt, because the commandment states: "And you shall tell your son on that day, saying: 'it is because of this that The Eternal did for me when I left Egypt.'" Not only did the Blessed and Holy One redeem our ancestors from Egypt, but He even redeemed us along with them, because the verse says: "And it was us that He brought out from there, in order to bring us to the land that will give us, as He swore to our ancestors."

אֶתְּנוּ לָתֶת לָנוּ אֶת הָאָרֶץ
אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּע לֹאֲבוֹתֵינוּ.

THE BRIDGE FROM MAGGID TO HALLEL

Raise the cup of wine while reciting the following paragraph:

לְפִיכָךְ אֲנַחֲנוּ חַיִּים
לְהוֹדוֹת, לְהַלֵּל, לְשַׁבַּח,
לְפָאֵר, לְרוֹמֵם, לְהַדָּר,
לְבָרֵךְ, לְעֵלֶה וּלְקַלֵּס לְמִי
שֶׁעָשָׂה לֹאֲבוֹתֵינוּ וְלָנוּ אֶת
כָּל הַנִּסִּים הָאֵלֶּה: הוֹצִיאָנוּ
מֵעֲבָדוֹת לְחֵירוֹת, מִיָּגוֹן
לְשִׂמְחָה, וּמֵאֲבֵל לְיוֹם טוֹב,
וּמֵאֲפֵלָה לְאוֹר גָּדוֹל,
וּמִשְׁעָבוֹד לְגִאֲלָה. וְנֹאמַר
לְפָנָיו שִׁירָה חֲדָשָׁה:
הַלְלוּיָהּ.

Therefore we are obligated to thank, to extoll, to praise, to glorify, to exalt, to adore, to bless, to elevate and to honor the One Who did all these miracles for our ancestors and for us. He took us from slavery to freedom, from sorrow to joy, and from mourning to celebration, and from black void to great light, and from bondage to redemption. Therefore we must say before Him a new psalm, Halleluyah!

הַלְלוּ יְהוָה הַלְלוּ עַבְדֵי יְהוָה
הַלְלוּ אֶת שֵׁם יְהוָה. יְהִי
שֵׁם יְהוָה מְבֹרָךְ מֵעַתָּה וְעַד
עוֹלָם. מִמְּזֶרֶח שֶׁמֶשׁ עַד
מְבוֹאוֹ מְהֵלֵל שֵׁם יְהוָה. רַם
עַל כָּל גּוֹיִם יְהוָה עַל

Halleluyah! Offer praise, servants of The Eternal; praise The Eternal Name. May The Eternal's Name be a source of blessings from now until forever. From the sun's rising to its setting, The Eternal's Name is praised. The Eternal is high above all nations; His glory is

הַשָּׁמַיִם כְּבוֹדוֹ. מִי כִּיהוָה
אֱלֹהֵינוּ הַמְּגִבִּיהִי לַשָּׁבֶת.
הַמְּשַׁפִּילִי לָרְאוֹת בַּשָּׁמַיִם
וּבָאָרֶץ. מְקִימִי מַעְפָּר דָּל
מֵאֲשֻׁפֹּת יָרִים אֶבְיוֹן.
לְהוֹשִׁיבִי עִם נְדִיבִים עִם
נְדִיבֵי עַמּוֹ. מוֹשִׁיבִי עֵקֶרֶת
הַבַּיִת אִם הַבָּנִים שְׂמִיחָה
הִלְלוּ יְהוָה.

בְּצֵאת יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמִּצְרַיִם
בֵּית יַעֲקֹב מֵעַם לֵעָז. הִיִּתָּה
יְהוּדָה לְקֹדֶשׁוֹ יִשְׂרָאֵל
מִמְּשֻׁלוֹתָיו. הָיָם רָאָה וַיָּנֹס
הַיַּרְדֵּן יָסֹב לְאַחֹר. הַהָרִים
רָקְדוּ כְּאַיִלִּים גְּבָעוֹת כְּבָנִי
צֹאן. מַה לָּךְ הָיָם כִּי תָנוּס
הַיַּרְדֵּן תִּסָּב לְאַחֹר. הַהָרִים
תִּרְקְדוּ כְּאַיִלִּים גְּבָעוֹת כְּבָנִי
צֹאן. מִלִּפְנֵי אֲדֹנָן חוֹלֵי אֶרֶץ
מִלִּפְנֵי אֱלֹהֵי יַעֲקֹב. הַהֶפְכִי
הַצּוֹר אֶגֶם מִיָּם חֲלָמִישׁ
לִמְעֵינוּ מִיָּם.

over the heavens. Who is like
The Eternal, our God, Who
dwells on high, yet allows His
Essence to descend upon heaven
and earth! He raises the poor
from the dust, He lifts the
destitute from the dung; to seat
them with nobles, with the
nobles of His people. He returns
the barren woman to the house
to become a joyful mother of
children. Halleluyah!

When Israel exited Egypt, the
House of Jacob from amongst a
people with a foreign tongue,
Judah became His holy one,
Israel became His dominion. The
sea saw and fled, the Jordan
turned backward. The
mountains danced like rams, the
hills like young sheep. What is
with you, O sea, that you flee; O
Jordan, that you turn backward?
Mountains, why do you skip like
rams; hills, like young sheep? It is
because you are before your
Master, the sands of the earth
are before the God of Jacob. It is
because The Rock overturns a
swamp into a flowing spring of
water.

Raise the cup of wine and recite the following blessing:

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְיָ אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ
הָעוֹלָם, אֲשֶׁר גָּאָלָנוּ וְגָאֵל
אֶת אֲבוֹתֵינוּ מִמִּצְרַיִם,
וְהִגִּיעָנוּ לַלַּיְלָה הַזֶּה לֶאֱכֹל
בּוֹ מַצָּה וּמָרוֹר. כֵּן יְיָ
אֱלֹהֵינוּ וְאֱלֹהֵי אֲבוֹתֵינוּ
יְגִיעֵנוּ לְמוֹעֲדִים וְלִרְגָלִים
אַחֲרִים הַבָּאִים לְקִרְאָתָנוּ
לְשָׁלוֹם, שְׂמִיחִים בְּבִנְיַן עִירְךָ
וְשִׁשִּׁים בַּעֲבוּדָתְךָ. וְנֹאכֵל
שֵׁם מִן הַזִּבְחִים וּמִן
הַפִּסְחִים אֲשֶׁר יִגִּיעַ דָּמָם
עַל קִיר מִזְבִּיחְךָ לְרָצוֹן,
וְנוֹדֶה לָּךְ שִׁיר חֹדֶשׁ עַל
גְּאֻלָּתָנוּ וְעַל פְּדוּת נַפְשֵׁנוּ.
בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְיָ גָּאֵל יִשְׂרָאֵל.
בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְיָ אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ
הָעוֹלָם בּוֹרֵא פְּרִי הַגֶּפֶן.

Blessed are You, The Eternal our God, King of the Universe, Who has redeemed us and our ancestors from Egypt, and brought us to this night to eat matzah and bitter vegetables. So too, Eternal, our God and God of our ancestors, bring us other holidays and festivals that will come to us in peace; with happiness in the rebuilding of Your city, and with rejoicing in Your Holy Temple service. May we there eat of the sacrifices and Paschal lambs whose blood shall be sprinkled on the wall of Your altar for acceptance; and we shall thank You with a new song for our redemption and for the reclaiming of our souls. Blessed are You, The Eternal, Who redeemed Israel.

Blessed are You, The Eternal our God, King of the Universe; Who creates the fruit of the vine.

Drink the cup of wine while reclining to the left.

The Seder continues with the ritual of Rachtzah, in which participants wash their hands (this time with the recitation of a blessing) as part of the standard process for breaking bread. Unlike Urchatz, Rachtzah does not deviate from commonplace Jewish rituals.

Fill a cup with water, and then pour it over each hand twice. (Some have the custom to pour three times.) Before drying your hands, recite the following blessing:

בְּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְיָ אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ	Blessed are You, The Eternal our
הָעוֹלָם, אֲשֶׁר קִדְּשָׁנוּ	God, King of the Universe; Who
בְּמִצְוֹתָיו וְצִוָּנוּ עַל נְטִילַת	has sanctified us with His
יָדַיִם.	commandments and has
	commanded us regarding the
	washing of hands.

Dry your hands with a towel.

After the washing of the hands, it is time to eat the matzah.

The commandment to eat matzah at the Seder is the only remaining mitzvah in which eating a particular item is considered the fulfillment of a biblical obligation. In the current era, any other commandment to eat a particular food (such as the bitter vegetables, which will be eaten next) are incumbent upon us only at a rabbinically-mandated level, so that we will not forget how our ancestors were able to fulfill the commandment to its utmost degree.

Because of this uniquely high degree of obligation, halachic authorities stress the gravity of the commandment to eat matzah; and thus provide conservative guidelines as to how much and how quickly one should eat matzah in order to satisfy even the most demanding interpretations in Jewish law. Therefore, the prevalent opinion is that one should eat a measurement of two *zeitim*¹ in a timespan of *k'dei achilat pras*², in order to satisfy all opinions. However, the precise definition of these Talmudic measurements is unclear; and thus there is further debate in which opinions are equally conservative in their estimates.

In practice, it is advisable that one consult with their local respected halachic authority to determine the precise amount to be consumed, and how long one may take to finish eating that required amount. If for some reason one has not been able to inquire or is physically incapable of consuming the suggested amount, one should steadily eat matzah until one's stomach begins to feel as though one has eaten. In effect, this usually entails eating at least three quarters of a matzah over the span of at least five minutes; which is likely to be the smallest amount of time it takes for one's stomach to indicate that it is no longer hungry. Regardless of the quantity and time required to fulfill the obligation, it is clear that one cannot fulfill their obligation by eating a small, cracker-sized quantity of matzah.

Raise the plate of matzah and recite the following two blessings:

בְּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ
הָעוֹלָם, הַמוֹצִיא לֶחֶם מִן
הָאָרֶץ. Blessed are You, The Eternal our
God, King of the Universe; Who
brings forth bread from the land.

בְּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ
הָעוֹלָם, אֲשֶׁר קִדְּשָׁנוּ
בְּמִצְוֹתָיו וְצִוָּנוּ עַל אֲכִילַת
מַצָּה. Blessed are You, The Eternal our
God, King of the Universe; Who
has sanctified us with His
commandments and has
commanded us regarding the
eating of the matzah.

Eat the required amount of matzah while reclining to the left.

¹The reason for eating two *zeitim* is so that the first *k'zeyit* will fulfill one's obligation to eat 'bread' on the holiday (a generic obligation that applies to all festivals), and the second *k'zeyit* to fulfill the biblically-mandated commandment to eat matzah.

Sephardic authorities generally maintain that a singular *k'zeyit* is 27 grams, therefore two *zeitim* would be 54 grams. Ashkenazic authorities base a *k'zeyit* on volume rather than weight, and have much more varied opinions as to the precise definition; although the commonly accepted measurement in weight for a *k'zeyit* is 29 grams; with two *zeitim* being 58 grams. Note that a single sheet of machine-made matzah is typically around 33 grams.

Almost all authorities acknowledge the difficulty of eating this much matzah, and suggest that at bare minimum, one should try to eat 19 grams, which is slightly less than two-thirds of a machine-made matzah. However, individuals should consult a local respected halachic

authority for more information and to determine the precise proper practice.

²The widely accepted timespan for *k'dei achilat pras* is approximately 4 minutes. However, this is the standard measurement that is used for commonplace halachic considerations; and may not be suitable with regard to eating matzah, where the convention is to be particularly strict. Some opinions indicate that when eating matzah, one should eat the required amount within even 2 minutes; others are skeptical, arguing that this may be physically impossible, especially given the opinions that suggest one need to eat almost two full sheets of matzah.

Some authorities maintain that as long as one does not take a break from eating, one may take as long as 18 minutes. Additionally, many feel that one need not rush while eating, which may be a factor into the timespan. As mentioned in the previous note, for those interested in the technicalities, one should seek out a qualified halachic authority.

After one has concluded eating the prescribed amount of matzah, it is time to eat the bitter vegetables.

While many have the common practice of using horseradish for marror, it is actually not the recommended food to serve this purpose. Horseradish is not an actual vegetable, it is a root; but more importantly, horseradish is sharp rather than bitter.

Horseradish came into popular practice due to the idea that because of its sharpness, it makes one cry; and these tears are supposed to remind one of the bitter tears of our ancestors. While this is certainly a noble aspect of the practice that should by no means be discouraged, it is preferable to use a vegetable that emphasizes the bitter taste in one's mouth. It is for this reason that romaine lettuce is often suggested. However, many opinions feel that romaine lettuce is not sufficiently bitter for use as marror, since it is commonly eaten as the main ingredient in salad.

However, other salad greens that are not typically the core element of a common salad make excellent choices for marror. Both endive and raddichio have strong, bitter flavors that stand out when eaten alone, and can be considered recommended vegetables for marror.

One should eat a *k'zeyit*¹ of marror after dipping it in *charoet*. Note that the intent is to use only a small amount of *charoet* when eating marror, as one should primarily taste the bitter essence of the vegetable. It is widely suggested that after dipping, one should actually shake off the *charoet*, since the act of dipping is merely symbolic rather than a fundamental aspect of the commandment to eat marror.

Recite the following blessing:

בְּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ	Blessed are You, The Eternal our
הָעוֹלָם, אֲשֶׁר קִדְּשָׁנוּ	God, King of the Universe; Who
בְּמִצְוֹתָיו וְצִוָּנוּ עַל אֲכִילַת	has sanctified us with His
מָרוֹר.	commandments and has
	commanded us regarding the
	eating of the bitter vegetables.

Eat the required amount of marror, but do not recline while doing so.

^lMost opinions agree that one may rely on the lenient measurements of a *k'zeyit* for the purpose of eating marror, which is approximately 19 grams. Notably, it is much easier to eat 19 grams worth of endive or raddichio than fresh horseradish.

After one has concluded eating the prescribed amount of bitter vegetables, there is an established custom to eat a sandwich ('korech' — to 'bundle') of both matzah and marror.

Most halachic authorities indicate that one should make their sandwich from one *k'zeyit* of matzah with one *k'zeyit* of marror, folding the matzah over so that it covers both sides of the bitter vegetables. However, all authorities recognize the difficulty of eating yet another *k'zeyit* of matzah and/or marror and suggest more lenient approaches, since Korech is largely symbolic rather than a direct fulfillment of a commandment. If necessary, a qualified halachic authority can be consulted to determine the proper guidelines.

Recite the following passage:

זָכַר לְמִקְדָּשׁ כְּהֵלֵל. כֵּן עָשָׂה הֵלֵל בְּזִמְנוֹ שְׁבִית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ הָיָה קָיָם: הָיָה כּוֹרֵךְ מַצָּה וּמָרֹר וְאוֹכֵל בְּיַחַד, לְקַיֵּם מֵה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: עַל מִצּוֹת וּמָרֹרִים יֹאכְלֶהוּ.	We do what Hillel did to commemorate what we used to do when the Holy Temple was still standing: he would combine the Paschal Lamb, the matzah and bitter vegetables, and then eat them together. He based this on an interpretation of the following verse: "They shall eat it [the Paschal Lamb] with matzah and bitter vegetables." This implies one must eat them not only within the same meal, but at exactly the same time.
---	---

Eat the matzah and marror sandwich while reclining to the left.

The main meal is served. It is customary to serve meat, fish, or poultry in accordance with the general obligations of a festive meal. Individuals may drink wine if they so choose; however, any wine consumed during the meal will not count towards the overall obligation to drink four cups of wine during the Passover Seder.

One should not eat excessively, as there will be an obligation to eat the Afikoman at the end of the meal, and one is not supposed to eat the Afikoman if they are bloated. In addition, the meal should not take an excessive amount of time, as the Afikoman needs to be eaten prior to chatzot, the halachic definition of midnight.

After the meal, it is time to eat the Afikoman; the matzah that was set aside earlier in the evening.

The Afikoman is the symbolic equivalent to eating the Paschal Lamb during the Passover Seder. As a result, there is great significance attached to it as well as guidelines intended to reflect the laws that were followed during the era when the Paschal Lamb was actually eaten.

Because of this, the Afikoman should be the last food consumed for the evening, and should be eaten before halachic midnight, which varies depending on the time of year. If one is still eating and halachic midnight arrives, one should eat a piece of matzah at that moment with the intent to fulfill the requirement to eat the Paschal Lamb before midnight, and then after finishing their meal, eat the Afikoman so that matzah remains as the last food eaten during the evening.

After partaking the Afikoman, one should refrain from eating; however, one may still consume wine, grape juice, or water.

Similar to the obligation to eat matzah and marror, it is recommended that one eat a *k'zeiyit* of the Afikoman. If there is not enough Afikoman (or it is misplaced) then any matzah will suffice. If one feels that they cannot eat this suggested quantity, it is advisable to at least chew the Afikoman for a significant quantity of time to insure that one adequately tastes the matzah. Similar to all other cases at the Seder, one should consult a local respected halachic authority to determine the proper practice.

Eat the required amount of matzah while reclining to the left.

The Seder continues with Grace After Meals. The third cup of wine should be poured at this time, and will be drunk afterwards. Afterwards, the Cup of Elijah will also be presented as a supplement to the third cup. Some have the custom to pour the cup of Elijah before the Seder or during Maggid; however, if it has not yet been poured, it is customary to wait to pour it until after Grace After Meals is completed.

This version of Grace After Meals follows popular Ashkenazi custom.

שִׁיר הַמַּעֲלוֹת. בְּשׁוּב יי אֶת
שִׁיבַת צִיּוֹן הָיִינוּ כְּחֹלְמִים:
אָז יִמְלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ
וְלִשׁוֹנֵנוּ רִנָּה. אָז יֹאמְרוּ
בַּגּוֹיִם הַגְּדִיל יי לַעֲשׂוֹת עִם
אֲלֹהֵי: הַגְּדִיל יי לַעֲשׂוֹת
עִמָּנוּ. הָיִינוּ שְׂמֵחִים: שׁוּבָה
יי אֶת שְׁבִיתֵנוּ כְּאֶפְיָקִים
בְּנֶגֶב: הִזְרַעִים בְּדִמְעָה
בְּרִנָּה יִקְצְרוּ: הָלוֹךְ יֵלֵךְ
וּבָכָה נִשָּׂא מִשָּׁךְ הִזְרַע. בֹּא
יבֹא בְרִנָּה. נִשָּׂא אֶלְמָתָיו:

A Song of Praises: When The Eternal returned the refugees of Zion, it was if we were dreamers. It was then that our mouths were filled with laughter and our tongues with song. Then it was said among the nations: "God has showed His Greatness for these people." God *has* showed His Greatness on our behalf, and we rejoiced. Return us refugees from exile, O Eternal, like the streams in Israel's southern desert. Those who sow in tears shall reap in joy. The one who walks — the one who goes forth weeping, carrying sacks of seeds — should come back in joy, bearing the sheaves [that have grown from them].

When benching with a zimmun — usually defined as the presence of three males above the age of bar-mitzvah — the following preface to Grace After Meals is recited line by line, beginning with the leader. (If a full minyan is present, then the words in parentheses should also be recited.) The leader should hold his third cup of wine until noted, with the specific intention of reciting Grace over the wine.

רַבּוֹתֵי נְבִירָךְ: Gentlemen, let us recite grace.

יְהִי שֵׁם יי מְבֹרָךְ מֵעַתָּה
וְעַד עוֹלָם: May the name of The Eternal be
praised from now until forever.

בְּרִשּׁוֹת מָרְנָן וְרַבָּנָן וְרַבּוֹתֵי
נְבִירָךְ (אֱלֹהֵינוּ) שְׂאֵבְלָנוּ
מִשְׁלֹ: With the permission of all
attending, let us acknowledge
Him (our God) for His food that
we have eaten.

בָּרוּךְ (אֱלֹהֵינוּ) שְׂאֵבְלָנוּ
מִשְׁלֹ וּבְטוֹבוֹ חַיֵּינוּ: Blessed is He (our God) of
Whose food we have eaten and
that His goodness sustains us.

בָּרוּךְ הוּא וּבָרוּךְ שְׁמוֹ: He is blessed and His name is
blessed.

Grace After Meals continues from here, even without a zimmun.

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ
הָעוֹלָם. הֵזֵן אֶת הָעוֹלָם
כָּלּוּ. בְּטוֹבוֹ בִּיחַן בְּחָסֶד
וּבְרַחֲמִים. הוּא נוֹתֵן לֶחֶם
לְכָל בָּשָׂר. כִּי לְעוֹלָם חֶסֶדְךָ:
וּבְטוֹבוֹ הַגָּדוֹל תִּמְיֵד לֹא
חֶסֶר לָנוּ וְאֵל יִחְסַר לָנוּ
Blessed are You, The Eternal our
God, King of the Universe, Who
sustains the entire world with
goodness, graciousness and
mercy. He gives bread to all
flesh, for His mercy is
everlasting. And through His
immense goodness we do not,
and pray we will not, lack
sustenance; for the sake of His
great name, since He is God

מִזוֹן לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד. בְּעִבּוֹר
שְׁמוֹ הַגָּדוֹל. כִּי הוּא אֵל זָן
וּמַפְרִיֵּס לְכָל וּמַטִּיב לְכָל
וּמַכִּין מִזוֹן לְכָל בְּרִיּוֹתָיו
אֲשֶׁר בָּרָא: בְּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי.
הֵזַן אֶת הַכֹּל:

נוֹדָה לְךָ יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ. עַל
שֶׁהִנְחַלְתָּ לְאַבּוֹתֵינוּ אֶרֶץ
חֲמֻדָּה טוֹבָה וְרַחֲבָה. וְעַל
שֶׁהוֹצֵאתָנוּ יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ
מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם. וּפְדִיתָנוּ
מִבֵּית עֲבָדִים. וְעַל בְּרִיתְךָ
שֶׁחֲתַמְתָּ בְּבָשָׁרֵנוּ. וְעַל
תּוֹרַתְךָ שֶׁלַּמִּדְתָּנוּ. וְעַל
חֻקֶּיךָ שֶׁהוֹדַעְתָּנוּ. וְעַל חַיִּים
חַן וְחֶסֶד שֶׁחֻנַּנְתָּנוּ. וְעַל
אֲכִילַת מִזוֹן שֶׁאַתָּה זָן
וּמַפְרִיֵּס אוֹתָנוּ תָּמִיד. בְּכָל
יוֹם וּבְכָל עֵת וּבְכָל שָׁעָה:

וְעַל הַכֹּל יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ אֲנִיחָנוּ
מוֹדִים לְךָ וּמְבָרְכִים אוֹתְךָ.
יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמֶךָ בְּפִי כָל חַי
תָּמִיד לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד: כִּפְתּוּב.
וְאֲכַלְתָּ וְשָׂבַעְתָּ וּבֵרַכְתָּ אֶת

Who sustains and provides all,
does good to all, and prepares
food for all the creatures that He
created. Blessed are You, The
Eternal, Who sustains
everything.

We thank You, The Eternal our
God, for having endowed to our
ancestors a lovely, good, and
spacious land; and for The
Eternal our God taking us out
from the land of Egypt and
redeeming us from the house of
slavery; for Your covenant [of
circumcision] which You have
sealed in our flesh; and for Your
Torah of which we have been
taught; for Your laws of which
we have been informed; for the
life, grace and loving kindness
which has been bestowed upon
us; and for the sustenance with
which God continuously sustains
and provides for us, every day in
every season, at every time.

For everything, The Eternal our
God, we thank You and bless
You. May Your name be blessed
in the mouth of every living
being forever, as it is written:
"And you will eat, and you will be
satiated, and you will bless The

יְיָ אֱלֹהֶיךָ עַל הָאָרֶץ הַטֹּבָה
אֲשֶׁר נָתַן לָךְ: בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה
יְיָ. עַל הָאָרֶץ וְעַל הַמָּזוֹן:

רַחֵם נָא יְיָ אֱלֹהֵינוּ עַל
יִשְׂרָאֵל עַמְּךָ. וְעַל יְרוּשָׁלַיִם
עִירְךָ. וְעַל צִיּוֹן מִשְׁכַּן
כְּבוֹדְךָ. וְעַל מַלְכוּת בֵּית דָּוִד
מְשִׁיחֶךָ. וְעַל הַבַּיִת הַגָּדוֹל
וְהַקְדוֹשׁ שְׁנִקְרָא שְׁמֶךָ
עָלֵינוּ: אֱלֹהֵינוּ. אָבִינוּ. רַעֲנוּ
זִנְנוּ פִּרְנִסְנוּ וְכֻלְכְּלֵנוּ
וְהַרְוִיחֵנוּ. וְהַרְוַח לָנוּ יְיָ
אֱלֹהֵינוּ מִהֶרָה מִכָּל
צָרוֹתֵינוּ. וְנָא אֵל תַּצְרִיכֵנוּ
יְיָ אֱלֹהֵינוּ לֹא לַיָּדַי מִתְּנֵת
בְּשָׁר וָדָם וְלֹא לַיָּדַי
הַלּוֹאֲתָם. כִּי אִם לַיָּדְךָ
הַמְּלֵאָה. הַפְּתוּחָה.
הַקְדוּשָׁה וְהַרְחֲבָה. שְׁלֹא
נִבּוֹשׁ וְלֹא נִכָּלֵם לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד:

Eternal your God for the good
land that He has given you."
Blessed are You, The Eternal, for
the land and its sustenance.

May You, The Eternal our God,
have mercy on Your nation
Israel; and on Your city
Jerusalem; and on Zion, the
abode of Your Glory; and on the
royal house of David, Your
anointed one; and on the great
and holy Temple that bears Your
Name. Our God, our Father,
[please] tend us, sustain us,
provide for us, nourish us,
bestow us [with what we need to
fulfill our need], and quickly
relieve us from all of our
troubles. Please, The Eternal our
God, do not make us dependent
on the charity of mankind or
loans of others, but rather on
Your full, open, holy and
generous Hand, so that we may
never be embarrassed or
humiliated.

On the Sabbath, the following paragraph should be included:

רָצָה וְהַחֲלִיצֵנוּ יְיָ אֱלֹהֵינוּ
בְּמִצְוֹתֶיךָ וּבְמִצְוֹת יוֹם
הַשְּׁבִיעִי הַשַּׁבָּת הַגָּדוֹל
וְהַקָּדוֹשׁ הַזֶּה. כִּי יוֹם זֶה
גָּדוֹל וְקָדוֹשׁ הוּא לְפָנֶיךָ
לְשַׁבֵּת בּוֹ וּלְנוּחַ בּוֹ בְּאַהֲבָה
כְּמִצְוֹת רְצוֹנְךָ. וּבְרָצוֹנְךָ
הַנִּיחַ לָנוּ יְיָ אֱלֹהֵינוּ שְׁלֹא
תִּהְיֶה צָרָה וְיָגוֹן וְאַנְחָה
בְּיוֹם מְנוּחָתֵנוּ. וְהִרְאֵנוּ יְיָ
אֱלֹהֵינוּ בְּנִחְמַת צִיּוֹן עִירְךָ
וּבְבִנְיִן יְרוּשָׁלַיִם עִיר קֹדֶשְׁךָ
כִּי אַתָּה הוּא בֹּעַל
הַיְשׁוּעוֹת וּבֹעַל הַנְּחָמוֹת.

Satisfy and strengthen us, The Eternal our God, with Your commandments and the commandment of the seventh day, this great and holy Sabbath, because today is great and holy before You; to rest and to relax on with love according to Your will. And may it be Your will to grant us comfort, O Eternal our God, so that we have no trouble, despair or grief on our day of rest. Show us, The Eternal our God, the comfort of Your city Zion, and the rebuilding of Jerusalem, Your Holy City; because You are the Master of Salvation and Comfort.

אֱלֹהֵינוּ וְאֱלֹהֵי אֲבוֹתֵינוּ
יַעֲלֶה וְיָבוֹא וְיִגִּיעַ וְיִרְאֶה
וְיִרְצֶה וְיִשְׁמַע וְיִפְקֹד וְיִזְכֹּר
זְכוֹרֵנוּ וּפְקֻדוֹתֵנוּ וְזִכְרוֹן
אֲבוֹתֵינוּ וְזִכְרוֹן מְשִׁיחַ בֶּן
דָּוִד עֶבְדְּךָ וְזִכְרוֹן יְרוּשָׁלַיִם
עִיר קֹדֶשְׁךָ וְזִכְרוֹן כָּל עַמְּךָ
בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל לְפָנֶיךָ לְפִלִּיטָה
לְטוֹבָה לְחֵן וּלְחַסֵּד

Our God and God of our ancestors — ascend, come, approach, show, desire, listen, recall, and remember our memories and recollections, the memory of our ancestors, the memory of the Messiah from the lineage of David, Your servant; the memory of Jerusalem, Your holy city; and the memory of all of Your nation, the House of Israel, before You, for respite, goodness, favor, kindness,

וְלִרְחֻמִּים לְחַיִּים וְלִשְׁלוֹם
 בְּיוֹם חַג הַמַּצּוֹת הַזֶּה זְכֵרְנוּ
 יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ בּוֹ לְטוֹבָה וּפְקֻדָּנוּ
 בּוֹ לְבִרְכָּה וְהוֹשִׁיעֵנוּ בּוֹ
 לְחַיִּים. וּבְדָבָר יִשׁוּעָה
 וְרַחֲמִים חוּס וְחַנּוּנוּ וְרַחֲמִים
 עָלֵינוּ וְהוֹשִׁיעֵנוּ כִּי אֱלֹהֶיךָ
 עֵינֵינוּ כִּי אֵל מֶלֶךְ חַנּוּן
 וְרַחוּם אַתָּה:

mercy, life, and peace on this Festival of Matzot. Remember us, O Eternal our God, on it for goodness and recall us on it for blessing, and save us on it for life. And in this matter of salvation and mercy, pity, grace us, and have mercy on us, and save us; as our eyes are to You because You are God, the Gracious and Merciful King.

Many Ashkenazi Jews have the custom to recite the parenthesized word in the following paragraph, even though it does not appear in the original text of Grace After Meals that is found in the Talmud.

וּבִנְה יְרוּשָׁלַּיִם עִיר הַקֹּדֶשׁ
 בְּמַהֲרָה בְּיָמֵינוּ. בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה
 יי. בּוֹנֵה (בְּרַחֲמָיו) יְרוּשָׁלַּיִם:
 אָמֵן:

[Please] rebuild Jerusalem, the holy city, speedily in our days. Blessed are You, The Eternal, Who (mercifully) rebuilds Jerusalem. Amen.

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ
 הָעוֹלָם. הָאֵל. אָבִינוּ. מְלִכְנוּ.
 אֲדִירְנוּ. בּוֹרְאֵנוּ. גּוֹאֲלֵנוּ.
 יוֹצֵרְנוּ. קְדוֹשֵׁנוּ קְדוֹשׁ יַעֲקֹב.
 רוֹעֵנוּ רוֹעֵה יִשְׂרָאֵל. הַמֶּלֶךְ
 הַטּוֹב וְהַמְּטִיב לְכָל. שֶׁבְּכָל
 יוֹם וַיּוֹם הוּא הַטִּיב הוּא
 מְטִיב הוּא יִיטִיב לָנוּ. הוּא
 גִּמְלָנוּ הוּא גּוֹמְלָנוּ הוּא

Blessed is The Eternal our God, King of the Universe, Who is our God, our Father, our King, our Exalted, our Creator, our Redeemer, our Maker, the Holy One Who Sanctified Jacob, our Shepherd of Israel, the Good King who does good to all — for every day He has benefitted us, benefits us, and will benefit us. He was, is, and will attend to us forever in grace, kindness, mercy, abundance, deliverance,

יְגַמְלֵנוּ לְעַד לַחַן וְלֶחֶסֶד
וְלִרְחָמִים וְלָרוּחַ הַצָּלָה
וְהַצִּלָּה בִּרְכָה וְיִשׁוּעָה
נְחֵמָה פְּרִנָּסָה וְכִלְכָּלָה
וְרַחֲמִים וְחַיִּים וְשָׁלוֹם וְכָל
טוֹב, וּמִכָּל טוֹב לְעוֹלָם אֶל
יְחִסְרָנוּ:

blessing, salvation, consolation,
monetary means, sustenance,
mercy, life, peace, and all
goodness; and [we pray] that
from this goodness, may God
never withhold any of it from us.

When reciting with a zimmun, the leader may put down his cup of wine.

הַרְחֵמֶן הוּא יְמֹלֵךְ עָלֵינוּ
לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד:
הַרְחֵמֶן הוּא יִתְבָּרֵךְ בְּשָׁמַיִם
וּבָאָרֶץ:
הַרְחֵמֶן הוּא יִשְׁתַּבַּח לְדוֹר
דּוֹרִים, וְיִתְפָּאֵר בָּנוּ לְעַד
וְלִנְצַח נְצָחִים, וְיִתְהַדָּר בָּנוּ
לְעַד וְלְעוֹלָמֵי עוֹלָמִים:
הַרְחֵמֶן הוּא יִפְרִנֵּסנוּ
בְּכָבוֹד:
הַרְחֵמֶן הוּא יִשְׁבֵּר עָלֵנוּ
מֵעַל צְוֹאֲרֵנוּ וְהוּא יוֹלִיכֵנוּ
קוֹמָמִיּוֹת לְאַרְצֵנוּ:
הַרְחֵמֶן הוּא יִשְׁלַח לָנוּ
בִּרְכָה מְרֻבָּה בְּבֵית הַזֶּה וְעַל
שְׁלַחַן זֶה שְׂאֵבֵלֵנוּ עָלָיו:

May the Merciful One rule over
us forever and ever.
May the Merciful One be
blessed [from all places] in
heaven and earth.
May the Merciful One be praised
in all generations, glorified by us
forever in the most extolled
manner, and beautified by us
forever in all universes.
May the Merciful One provide
us monetary means in a
respectful fashion.
May the Merciful One break the
yoke [of burdens] upon us, upon
our necks, and may He bring us
from the farthest corners of the
earth to our homeland.
May the Merciful One send us a
blessing of abundance to this
house and to this table that we
dine at.
May the Merciful One send us
the Prophet Elijah, who will

הַרְחֵמֶן הוּא יִשְׁלַח לָנוּ אֶת
אֱלֹהֵינוּ הַנְּבִיא זְכוּר לְטוֹב
וַיִּבְשֹׁר לָנוּ בְּשׁוּרוֹת טוֹבוֹת
יְשׁוּעוֹת וְנִחְמוֹת:

remember us for good and
herald great proclamations of
salvation and consolation [i.e.
the arrival of the Messiah].

The following paragraph is a blessing bestowed upon the host, the host's spouse, and the host's children and grandchildren. Even the host is expected to request a blessing on his or her behalf, although many have the custom to include their guests as well. In the presence of one's parents, grandparents, rabbi, or teachers, it is customary to acknowledge them first. Each participant should recite the next paragraph accordingly.

הַרְחֵמֶן הוּא יְבָרֵךְ אֶת (אָבִי
מוֹרִי) בְּעַל הַבֵּית הַזֶּה וְאֶת
(אִמִּי מוֹרְתִי) בְּעַלֹּת הַבֵּית
הַזֶּה. אוֹתָם וְאֶת בֵּיתָם וְאֶת
זֶרְעָם וְאֶת כָּל אֲשֶׁר לָהֶם.
(הַרְחֵמֶן הוּא יְבָרֵךְ אוֹתִי
וְאֶת אִשְׁתִּי וְאֶת זֶרְעִי וְאֶת
כָּל אֲשֶׁר לִי/לָנוּ), אוֹתָנוּ
וְאֶת כָּל אֲשֶׁר לָנוּ. כָּמוֹ
שֶׁנִּתְבָּרְכוּ אֲבוֹתֵינוּ אַבְרָהָם
יִצְחָק וְיַעֲקֹב, בְּכָל. מְכָל. כָּל.
כֵּן יְבָרֵךְ אוֹתָנוּ כָּלָנוּ יַחַד
בְּבִרְכָּה שְׁלֵמָה. וְנֹאמַר
אָמֵן:

May the Merciful One bless
(my father / my mother / my
grandfather / my grandmother /
my rabbi / my teacher),
(me / my wife / my husband / our
children / our grandchildren /
our guests),
(the host / his wife / her husband
/ their children / their
grandchildren),
us and everything that is ours;
just as our ancestors Abraham,
Isaac, and Jacob have been
blessed with everything, from
everything, and in every way. In
this vein, may He bless us all
together with a comprehensive
blessing — and we shall say
Amen.

בְּמָרוֹם יִלְמְדוּ עֲלֵיהֶם וְעֲלֵינוּ
זְכוּת שְׁתֵּיהֶא לְמִשְׁמֶרֶת
שָׁלוֹם. וְנִשָּׂא בִּרְכָה מֵאֵת
יְי. וְצִדְקָה מֵאֱלֹהֵי יִשְׁעֵנוּ.
וְנִמְצָא חֵן וְשׂוֹכֵל טוֹב בְּעֵינֵי
אֱלֹהִים וְאָדָם:

In the Highest of Heights, may merit be transmitted to them [those we have just blessed] and to us, so that we may take part in an era of peace; and a blessing from The Eternal will be carried forth, with righteousness from the God of our salvation, so that grace and good sense are found in the eyes of God and man.

On the Sabbath, include the following:

הַרְחֵמֶן הוּא יִנְחִילֵנוּ לְיוֹם
שְׁכָלוֹ שַׁבָּת וּמְנוּחָה לְחַיֵּי
הָעוֹלָמִים:

May the Merciful One hand down to us a day that is entirely Sabbatical and a rest for all inhabitants of the universe.

הַרְחֵמֶן הוּא יִנְחִילֵנוּ יוֹם
שְׁכָלוֹ טוֹב:

May the Merciful One hand down to us a day that is entirely good.

הַרְחֵמֶן הוּא יִזְכֵּנוּ לְיָמֵי
הַמָּשִׁיחַ וּלְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא:

May the Merciful One merit us [to see] the days of the Messiah and to live in the World to Come.

מִגְדוֹל יִשׁוּעוֹת מֶלֶכּוֹ וְעֹשֶׂה
חֶסֶד לְמַשִּׁיחוֹ לְדָוִד וּלְזֶרְעוֹ
עַד עוֹלָם: עֹשֶׂה שָׁלוֹם
בְּמָרוֹמָיו הוּא יַעֲשֶׂה שָׁלוֹם
עֲלֵינוּ וְעַל כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל
וְאָמְרוּ אָמֵן:

The King's salvations are a tower [that watches over us]; and He does kindness for His anointed one, David and his offspring, forever.

He Who makes peace in His Highest of Heights, may He establish peace for us and for all of Israel, and let us say: Amen.

יִרְאוּ אֶת יי קְדוֹשׁוֹ כִּי אֵין
מַחְסוֹר לִירְאָיו: כְּפִירִים
רָשׁוּ וְרָעִבוּ וְדוֹרְשֵׁי יי לֹא
יִחְסְרוּ כָּל טוֹב: הוֹדוּ לֵי כִי
טוֹב כִּי לְעוֹלָם חֶסֶדוֹ: פּוֹתֵחַ
אֶת יָדָךְ וּמִשְׁבִּיעַ לְכָל חַי
רְצוֹן: בָּרוּךְ הַגָּבֵר אֲשֶׁר
יִבְטַח בִּי וְהָיָה יי מְבִטְחוֹ:
נֶעַר הָיִיתִי גַם זָקֵנְתִי וְלֹא
רָאִיתִי צָדִיק נִפְעָז וְזָרְעוֹ
מִבִּקֵּשׁ לֶחֶם: יי עֹז לַעֲמוֹ
יִתֵּן יי יְבָרֵךְ אֶת עַמּוֹ
בְּשָׁלוֹם:

Be in awe of The Eternal, His
Consecrated; for there will be no
lacking for those who look to
him with awe. Those who deny
Him are destitute and hungry,
but those who seek The Eternal
shall not lack anything that is
good. Express gratitude to The
Eternal, for He is good; God's
kindness endures forever. He
opens His Hand and satiates
every living thing with will.
Blessed is the man who trusts in
The Eternal, for The Eternal will
be his promise. "I have been a
youth, and I have also been an
elder, but I have not seen a saint
abandoned, nor that person's
offspring begging for bread."
May The Eternal give strength to
our people; may The Eternal
bless our people with peace.

All participants should raise their glass of wine. If a zimmun was present for Grace, the leader of the zimmun should lead the recitation of the blessing for the third cup of wine.

סִבְרֵי מָרְנָן וְרַבָּנָן וְרַבּוֹתֵי: Attention all:

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ
הָעוֹלָם, בּוֹרֵא פְּרֵי הַגָּפֶן.
Blessed are You, The Eternal our
God, King of the Universe; Who
creates the fruit of the vine.

Drink the cup of wine. One should lean to the left while drinking.

The Seder continues with the Cup of Elijah.

Pour a separate cup of wine (i.e. one not already belonging to a participant of the Seder) and place it on the table. Many have the custom to open a door to their residence while reciting the next paragraph. The Cup of Elijah should not be partaken of, but rather left on the table until the conclusion of the Seder.

שְׂפֹךְ חֲמַתְךָ אֶל הַגּוֹיִם	Pour your wrath on the nations
אֲשֶׁר לֹא יִדְעוּךָ וְעַל	that do not acknowledge You ¹
מַמְלָכוֹת אֲשֶׁר בְּשִׁמְךָ לֹא	and on the kingdoms that do not
קָרְאוּ: כִּי אָכַל אֶת יַעֲקֹב	call out Your Name – For they
וְאֶת נְוֹהוֹ הֵשִׁמּוּ: שְׂפֹךְ	have devoured Jacob and have
עֲלֵיהֶם זַעֲמֶךָ וַחֲרוֹן אַפֶּךָ	devastated his habitats. Pour
יִשְׁיִגֵּם: תִּרְדֹּף בְּאֵף	upon them Your fury, and let
וְתִשְׁמִידֵם מִתַּחַת שָׁמַיִי יי:	Your anger overtake them.
	Pursue them in anger and
	persecute them under The
	Eternal's heavens.

¹The paragraph recited over the Cup of Elijah is of a drastically different sentiment than previous points in the Seder. Many may even feel uncomfortable by this seemingly vengeful and spiteful inclusion, or be confused as to why this particular passage is chosen to be recited in reference to Elijah's Cup.

One must understand that the holiday of Passover, first and foremost, is a holiday about Jewish identity. This identity is not merely spiritual, but also national. Passover does not merely reflect that Jews share the same religion, but that we are members of a single nation, no matter how scattered we are across the world. We take this time to reflect on how we have a unique mission, how we are supposed to lead other nations to

enlightenment rather than assume we are no different than the rest of the world.

The Egyptians attempted to eradicate us. They would not be the last nation to rise up and attempt to annihilate us. Many others would try, from Haman of Purim to Antiochus of Chanukah and their modern-era counterparts, Hitler and Eichmann of the Nazis, Hamas, Hezbollah, and the Ayatollah. Yet even during our darkest times, God has never allowed us to be completely destroyed. We have always survived.

Until this point, the Haggadah has been reflective of the past and how it has shaped us. We are thankful for what The Almighty has done for us, and grateful for what He continues to do for us. Elijah, however, is an emissary of the future. It is at this point in the Seder that we begin to not only look at how the past has shaped the present, but how the present will shape the future. What we are thankful for now will form our outlook for the future. Similarly, we cannot adequately face that future if we do not recognize the reality of the present.

As much as we strive for a world of peace and tolerance for all, at this juncture the Haggadah wants to remind us that there are those who do not. There is evil in the world, and it does not want the same outcome — and those that have forsaken their moral authority by unjustly persecuting us cannot be dismissed. We cannot overlook their rejection of The Eternal's desire for mankind to live in peace and harmony. We cannot just meekly hope that they will eventually change their worldview; that we can negotiate with those who wish to destroy us. It takes more than our hope for peace; the other side must respect our right to exist.

The key message is that it is not enough to be merely free. We also must know that freedom is worth fighting for, over and over again. We must remind ourselves that even while we celebrate our freedom, we are not yet done fighting for it. True peace can only come after Elijah arrives to

herald the Messiah, and before then, we ask that God remove those who wish otherwise.

Thus, if only for a paragraph, the Haggadah takes a moment to drastically shift tone. The remainder of the Seder, Hallel and Nirtzah, correspond to the freedom of worship and celebration that underscore our true redemption from slavery. Yet as long as there are those who still wish to destroy us, our freedom is constrained. The Haggadah wants us to take this moment to beseech God to free us from those who may wish to re-enslave us, even if it breaks from our celebration and revelry. It is only then, after we acknowledge the challenges still yet to come, that we are prepared to continue with the Seder.

Pour the fourth cup of wine. It will be drunk after Hallel.

The first two paragraphs of the traditional Hallel liturgy were recited at the end of Maggid, so Hallel continues from the third paragraph. In addition to the standard text of Hallel, additional prayers from the holiday liturgy are included. Singing is encouraged, and it is meritorious to recall and recount personal thanks to God that inspire and foster an atmosphere of gratitude to the Almighty.

This version of Hallel follows popular Ashkenazi custom.

Hallel is intended to be a poetic set of praises that show our gratitude to God for all that He has done for us — not just in the past by saving us from Egyptian slavery, but also now and forever more. Many of the nuances, subtleties, and majesty of these praises from Psalms and the holiday liturgy are lost in translation. Furthermore, many of the passages in Psalms are nearly impossible to properly understand without the relevant historical context in which they were written — such as those penned while the nascent King David was fleeing King Saul. Therefore, while the translation that follows will aim to preserve the spirit of the Hebrew text, some liberties were taken in an effort to assist those who rely on the English text.

לֹא לָנוּ יְיָ לֹא לָנוּ, כִּי לְשִׁמְךָ	We sing not for us, but rather for
תָּנוּ כְּבוֹד, עַל חַסְדֶּךָ, עַל	You; it is not for us, but rather
אַמְתֶּךָ. לָמָּה יֹאמְרוּ הַגּוֹיִם	for God's true kindness. Other
אֵיךָ נָא אֱלֹהֵיהֶם, וְאֱלֹהֵינוּ	nations may challenge us to find
בַּשָּׁמַיִם, כֹּל אֲשֶׁר חָפֵץ	God, but we know that God is in
עֲשֶׂה. עֲצִבֵיהֶם כֶּסֶף וְזָהָב	the heavens and He does all that
	He desires. They worship silver
	and gold, the makes of man — a
	mouth with no voice, eyes with

מַעֲשֵׂה יְדֵי אָדָם. פֶּה לָהֶם
וְלֹא יִדְבְּרוּ, עֵינַיִם לָהֶם וְלֹא
יֵרְאוּ. אֲזָנַיִם לָהֶם וְלֹא
יִשְׁמְעוּ, אֶף לָהֶם וְלֹא
יֵרִיחוּן. יְדֵיהֶם וְלֹא יִמְיִשּׁוּן,
רַגְלֵיהֶם וְלֹא יִהְלְכוּ, לֹא
יִהְיוּ בְּגִרוֹנִם. כְּמוֹהֶם יִהְיוּ
עֹשֵׂיהֶם, כֹּל אֲשֶׁר בְּטַח
בָּהֶם. יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּטַח בְּיְיָ,
עֲזָרָם וּמִגְנָם הוּא. בֵּית
אַהֲרֹן בְּטַחוּ בְּיְיָ, עֲזָרָם
וּמִגְנָם הוּא. יִרְאִי יְיָ בְּטַחוּ
בְּיְיָ, עֲזָרָם וּמִגְנָם הוּא:

יְיָ זְכָרְנוּ יְבָרֶךְ, יְבָרֶךְ אֶת
בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל, יְבָרֶךְ אֶת בֵּית
אַהֲרֹן. יְבָרֶךְ יִרְאִי יְיָ,
הַקְטָנִים עִם הַגְּדֹלִים. יִסֹּף יְיָ
עֲלֵיכֶם, עֲלֵיכֶם וְעַל בְּנֵיכֶם.
בְּרוּכִים אַתֶּם לַיְיָ, עֹשֵׂה
שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ. הַשָּׁמַיִם
שָׁמַיִם לַיְיָ וְהָאָרֶץ נָתַן לַבְּנֵי
אָדָם. לֹא הַמֵּתִים יִהְלְלוּ יְיָ
וְלֹא כָּל יֹרְדֵי דוּמָה. וְאַנְחֵנוּ

no sight, ears that cannot even hear silence; a nose that inhales no scent, hands that sense nothing nor feet that travel, and a throat with no voice. Anyone who puts their faith in such soulless beings will undoubtedly become just like them. But we, the nation of Israel, should trust only in The Eternal, for He is our Assistance and our Shield. The house of Aaron should trust in The Eternal, our Assistance and our Shield. All who revere God should trust in The Eternal, our Assistance and our Shield.

Dear Eternal, Who remembers us — bless us, bless all of Israel and the House of Aaron. Bless those who revere You, from the youth to the eldest sages. God, please increase Your children and Your children's children — For You have said, "Blessed are you to The Eternal, He Who has made the heavens and earth." The heavens may be the realm of the Eternal, but the earth was given to mankind. The dead cannot praise God, the forevermore silent cannot praise God — That task is ours! We can

נְבָרַךְ יְהוָה מֵעַתָּה וְעַד עוֹלָם.
הַלְלוּיָהּ:

אֶהְבֶּתִּי כִּי יִשְׁמַע יי אֶת
קוֹלִי, תַּחֲנוּנֵי. כִּי הִטָּה אָזְנוֹ
לִי וּבִימֵי אֶקְרָא. אֶפְפוּנִי
חֲבָלֵי מוֹת וּמִצָּרֵי שְׁאוֹל
מִצְאוּנִי, צָרָה וַיְגוֹן אֶמְצָא.
וּבְשֵׁם יי אֶקְרָא, אָנָּה יי
מִלְטָה נַפְשִׁי. חֲנוּן יי וְצַדִּיק,
וְאֱלֹהֵינוּ מְרַחֵם. שֹׁמֵר
פְּתָאִים יי, דְּלוֹתֵי וְלִי
יְהוֹשִׁיעַ. שׁוּבִי נַפְשִׁי
לְמִנוּחַיִכִּי, כִּי יי גָּמַל עָלַיִכִּי.
כִּי חִלַּצְתָּ נַפְשִׁי מִמָּוֶת, אֶת
עֵינֵי מִן דִּמְעָה, אֶת רַגְלִי
מִדָּחִי. אֶתְהַלֵּךְ לִפְנֵי יי
בְּאַרְצוֹת הַחַיִּים. הָאֱמָנוּתִי
כִּי אֲדַבֵּר, אֲנִי עָנִיתִי מְאֹד.
אֲנִי אֶמְרֹתִי בְּחִפְזִי, כֹּל
הָאָדָם כֹּזֵב:

מָה אֶשְׁיב לַיי כֹּל תַּגְמוּלוֹהִי
עָלַי. כּוֹס יְשׁוּעוֹת אֶשָּׂא
וּבְשֵׁם יי אֶקְרָא. נְדָרֵי לַיי
אֲשַׁלֵּם נְגִידָה נָּא לְכֹל עַמּוֹ.

praise God, from now until
forever — Hallelujah!

I love God, because He listens to
me; my voice and prayers reach
Him. He turns His ear to hear my
cry, each and every day that I call
out to Him. The ropes of death
wish to encase me, the narrows
of the grave find me, where I
would find trouble and despair.
But it is at these times that I call
out His Name — "Please, God,
save my soul!" Gracious and
righteous as He is, our God has
mercy: For The Eternal watches
over the simple, and when I
descended to those depths, He
saved me. "Return to your rest,
My Soul, for I, God, have
bestowed kindness upon you." You
rescued my soul from death
when my eyes were full of tears
and my feet stumbled wherever
they went. Thus I shall walk
before God, in the land of the
living. I have kept faith despite
my great suffering — And when
others deny You, I am quick to
say that man is known to lie.

How can I repay The Eternal for
all the kindness that He has
bestowed upon me? I shall raise
my cup that symbolizes my
salvation, and I will call out His

יָקָר בְּעֵינַי יְיָ הַמּוֹתָה
 לַחֲסִידָיו. אָנָּה יְיָ כִּי אֲנִי
 עֲבָדְךָ, אֲנִי עֲבָדְךָ בֶּן אֲמָתְךָ,
 פְּתַחְתָּ לְמוֹסְרִי. לָךְ אֶזְבַּח
 זֶבַח תּוֹדָה וּבָשֵׁם יְיָ אֶקְרָא.
 נִדְרֵי לַיְי אֲשַׁלֵּם נִגְדָה נָּא
 לְכָל עַמּוֹ. בְּחִצְרוֹת בֵּית יְיָ,
 בְּתוֹכֵכִי יְרוּשָׁלַיִם, הַלְלוּיָהּ:

Name. I shall fulfill my promises to Him, for all our nation to see. We are precious in the Eyes of The Eternal, even though the most righteous of us must eventually pass on. Please, God, for I am Your servant — I am even Your servant's servant, for You have freed me from bondage. To You, I will sacrifice a thanksgiving offering, and call out Your Name. I shall fulfill my promises to The Eternal, for all our nation to see — there, in the courtyards of The Lord's House, the heart of Jerusalem — Hallelujah!

הַלְלוּ אֶת יְיָ כָּל גּוֹיִם,
 שִׁבְּחוּהוּ כָּל הָאֲמִים. כִּי
 גִבֹּר עָלֵינוּ חֲסִדּוֹ, וְאֶמֶת יְיָ
 לְעוֹלָם, הַלְלוּיָהּ:

All nations, extoll The Eternal! All peoples, praise Him! For His kindness alone sustains us, and that is the everlasting truth — Hallelujah!

The following four verses should be recited responsively.

הוֹדוּ לַיְי כִּי טוֹב,

Thank The Eternal, for He is good:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חֲסִדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

יֹאמְרוּ נָּא יִשְׂרָאֵל,

Proclaim, Israel:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חֲסִדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

יֹאמְרוּ נָּא בֵּית אַהֲרֹן,

Proclaim, House of Aaron:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חֲסִדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

יֹאמְרוּ נָא יְרֵאִי יְיָ,

Proclaim, those who awe The
Eternal:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חֶסֶדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

מִן הַמִּצָּר קָרָאתִי יְהוָה, עָנְנִי
בַּמֶּרְחֹב יְהוָה. יְיָ לִי לֹא אִירָא,
מָה יַעֲשֶׂה לִּי אָדָם. יְיָ לִי
בְּעֶזְרִי וְאֲנִי אֶרְאֶה בְּשׁוֹנְאֵי.
טוֹב לַחֲסוֹת בְּיְיָ מִבְּטַח
בְּאָדָם. טוֹב לַחֲסוֹת בְּיְיָ
מִבְּטַח בַּנְּדִיבִים. כָּל גּוֹיִם
סָבְבוּנִי, בְּשֵׁם יְיָ כִּי אֲמִילֵם.
סְבֻבוֹנִי גַם סָבְבוּנִי, בְּשֵׁם יְיָ
כִּי אֲמִילֵם. סְבֻבוֹנִי כְּדַבָּרִים,
דַּעְכוּ כְּאֵשׁ קוֹצִים, בְּשֵׁם יְיָ
כִּי אֲמִילֵם. דָּחָה דָּחִיתַנִּי
לִנְפֹל, וַיְיָ עֲזָרְנִי. עָזִי וְזִמְרַת
יְהוָה וַיְהִי לִי לִישׁוּעָה. קוֹל
רָנָה וִישׁוּעָה בְּאֶהְלִי
צַדִּיקִים, יָמִין יְיָ עֲשֶׂה חֵיל.
יָמִין יְיָ רוֹמְמָה, יָמִין יְיָ עֲשֶׂה
חֵיל. לֹא אָמוּת כִּי אֶחְיֶה,
וְאֶסְפָּר מַעֲשֵׂי יְהוָה. יִסֹּר
יִסְרְנִי יְהוָה, וְלִמּוֹת לֹא נִתְּנִי.
פִּתְחוּ לִי שַׁעֲרֵי צֶדֶק, אָבֹא

I called out to God from my
confines, and He provided me
with a limitless answer. When
God is with me, I have no fear —
what could mere man possibly
do to me? God supports me
through my companions and
assistants, so that I may face my
foes. It is better to seek
protection in God than the
promises of man. It is better to
seek protection in The Eternal
than the wealthy and
prestigious. All other nations
surround me, but in the name of
God, I cleave them. They
encompass me as they surround
me, but in the name of God, I
cleave them. They envelop me
like bees, but they will shrivel as
a bush of thorns cast in fire; in
the name of God, I cleave them. I
was shoved hard to topple me,
but The Eternal has assisted me.
The sound of joy and salvation
can be found in the tents of the
righteous, The Eternal's right
hand is indomitable. The
Eternal's right hand is His
Eminence; The Eternal's right
hand is valiant. I cannot die, for I

בָּם, אֹדָה יְהוָה. זֶה הַשַּׁעַר
 לִי, צְדִיקִים יִבְאוּ בוֹ. אֹדֶךְ
 כִּי עֲנִיתָנִי וַתְּהִי לִי לִישׁוּעָה.
 אֹדֶךְ כִּי עֲנִיתָנִי וַתְּהִי לִי
 לִישׁוּעָה. אָבֵן מַאֲסוֹ הַבּוֹנִים
 הָיְתָה לְרֹאשׁ פִּנֵּה. אָבֵן
 מַאֲסוֹ הַבּוֹנִים הָיְתָה לְרֹאשׁ
 פִּנֵּה. מֵאֵת יְיָ הָיְתָה זֹאת
 הִיא נִפְלְאָת בְּעֵינֵינוּ. מֵאֵת
 יְיָ הָיְתָה זֹאת הִיא נִפְלְאָת
 בְּעֵינֵינוּ. זֶה הַיּוֹם עָשָׂה יְיָ
 נִגִּילָה וְנִשְׁמְחָה בוֹ. זֶה הַיּוֹם
 עָשָׂה יְיָ נִגִּילָה וְנִשְׁמְחָה בוֹ:

must live; so that I may proclaim
 the deeds of God. God has made
 me suffer, but He has not handed
 me death. Open up the gates of
 righteousness for me, and I will
 come to them and thank The
 Lord. For this is The Eternal's
 gate, the righteous come to it.

I thank You for answering me,
 Your answer has been my
 salvation.

I thank You for answering me,
 Your answer has been my
 salvation.

The rock that was rejected by
 the architects has ultimately
 become the foundation's
 cornerstone.

The rock that was rejected by
 the architects has ultimately
 become the foundation's
 cornerstone.

All of this has been God's will,
 and it is a wondrous sight to
 behold.

All of this has been God's will,
 and it is a wondrous sight to
 behold.

This day was made by The
 Eternal, we shall rejoice and be
 happy with it.

This day was made by The
 Eternal, we shall rejoice and be
 happy with it!

The following four verses should be recited responsively.

אָנָּא יי, הוֹשִׁיעָה נָּא: Please, Eternal, save us!

אָנָּא יי, הוֹשִׁיעָה נָּא: Please, Eternal, save us!

אָנָּא יי, הַצְלִיחָה נָּא: Please, Eternal, help us succeed!

אָנָּא יי, הַצְלִיחָה נָּא: Please, Eternal, help us succeed!

בָּרוּךְ הֵבֵא בְּשֵׁם יי,
בִּרְכוּנוֹכֶם מִבֵּית יי. בָּרוּךְ
הֵבֵא בְּשֵׁם יי, בִּרְכוּנוֹכֶם

Blessed is one who comes in the
Name of The Eternal; we bless
you from The Eternal's House.

מִבֵּית יי. אֵל יי וַיָּאֵר לָנוּ.
אֶסְרוּ חַג בַּעֲבֹתֵים עַד
קַרְנוֹת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ. אֵל יי וַיָּאֵר

Blessed is one who comes in the
Name of The Eternal; we bless
you from The Eternal's House.

לָנוּ. אֶסְרוּ חַג בַּעֲבֹתֵים עַד
קַרְנוֹת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ. אֵל יי וַיָּאֵר
וְאוֹדֶךָ, אֱלֹהֵי אֲרוֹמְמָךְ. אֵלֵי

The Eternal is The Almighty, He
has illuminated us — prepare for
Him a festive offering on the
corners of the altar.

אֶתָּה וְאוֹדֶךָ, אֱלֹהֵי אֲרוֹמְמָךְ. אֵלֵי
אֶתָּה וְאוֹדֶךָ, אֱלֹהֵי
אֲרוֹמְמָךְ. הוֹדוּ לַיי כִּי טוֹב,

The Eternal is The Almighty, He
has illuminated us — prepare for
Him a festive offering on the
corners of the altar.

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חֲסִדוֹ. הוֹדוּ לַיי כִּי
טוֹב, כִּי לְעוֹלָם חֲסִדוֹ:

You are my Almighty God and I
will thank You, my God that I
exalt.

You are my Almighty God and I
will thank You, my God that I
exalt.

Thank God, for He is Good: His
kindness is neverending!

Thank God, for He is Good: His
kindness is neverending!

יְהִלְלוּךָ יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ כָּל
מַעֲשֶׂיךָ, וַחֲסִידֶיךָ צַדִּיקִים
עוֹשֵׂי רְצוֹנְךָ, וְכָל עַמְּךָ בֵּית

All of Your handiwork shall
praise You, The Eternal our God;
the pious saints who do Your
will. And the whole house of

יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּרָנָה יוֹדוֹ וַיְבָרְכוּ,
וַיִּשְׁבְּחוּ וַיְפָאֲרוּ, וַיְרוֹמְמוּ
וַיַּעֲרִיצוּ, וַיִּקְדִּישׁוּ וַיְמַלִּיכוּ
אֶת שְׁמֶךָ, מְלִכְנוּ. כִּי לְךָ
טוֹב לְהוֹדוֹת וּלְשַׁמֵּךְ נֶאֱמָה
לְזִמְרָה, כִּי מֵעוֹלָם וְעַד עוֹלָם
אַתָּה אֱלֹהִים:

Israel will gladly thank, bless, praise, glorify, exalt, laud, sanctify, and venerate Your Name, Our King! For it is good to thank You and pleasant to sing in Your Name, because in this world and the next, You will always be The Almighty God.

The following verses should either be recited responsively, or together in unison.

הוֹדוּ לַיְי כִּי טוֹב, Thank The Eternal, for He is Good:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חֲסִדוֹ: His kindness is neverending!

הוֹדוּ לֵאלֹהֵי הָאֱלֹהִים, Thank God of All Powers:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חֲסִדוֹ: His kindness is neverending!

הוֹדוּ לְאֲדֹנֵי הָאֲדֹנִים, Thank The Master of Masters:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חֲסִדוֹ: His kindness is neverending!

לַעֲשֹׂה נִפְלְאוֹת גְּדֻלוֹת לְבַדּוֹ, To The One Who makes great wonders all by Himself:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חֲסִדוֹ: His kindness is neverending!

לַעֲשֹׂה הַשָּׁמַיִם בְּתַבּוּנָה, To The One Who makes the heavens with insight:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חֲסִדוֹ: His kindness is neverending!

לְרוֹקַע הָאָרֶץ עַל הַמַּיִם, To The One Who encases earth on water in an atmosphere:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

לַעֲשֹׂה אוֹרִים גְּדֹלִים,

To The One Who makes the
great lights in the sky:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

אֶת הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ לְמַמְשָׁלָת
בַּיּוֹם,

Who established the sun that
rules by day:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

אֶת הַיָּרֵחַ וְכּוֹכָבִים
לְמַמְשָׁלוֹת בַּלַּיְלָה,

Who established the moon and
stars that rule by night:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

לְמַכֶּה מִצְרַיִם בְּבְכוֹרֵיהֶם,

To The One Who smote the
Egyptians via their firstborn:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

וַיּוֹצֵא יִשְׂרָאֵל מִתּוֹכָם,

And Who brought out Israel
from amongst them:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

בְּיָד חֲזָקָה וּבְזְרוּעַ נְטוּיָה,

With a strong hand and an
outstretched arm:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

לְגַזֵּר יָם סוּף לְגִזְרִים,

To The One Who sliced the Sea
of Reeds into channels:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

וְהָעֶבֶיר יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּתוֹכוֹ,

And Who led Israel into the sea:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

וְנִעַר פַּרְעֹה וְחִילוֹ בַיָּם סוּף,

And Who shook off Pharaoh and his army into the Sea of Reeds:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

לְמוֹלִיד עַמּוֹ בַּמִּדְבָּר,

To The One Who led His nation through the wilderness:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

לְמַכֵּה מְלָכִים גְּדֹלִים,

To The One Who smote great kings:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

וַיַּהַרֵג מְלָכִים אַדִּירִים,

And The One Who killed mighty kings:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

לְסִיחֹן מֶלֶךְ הָאֱמֹרִי,

Such as Sichon, King of the Emorites:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

וְלַעֹג מֶלֶךְ הַבָּשָׁן,

And such as Og, King of the Bashan:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

וְנָתַן אֶרְצָם לְנַחֲלָה,

And Who gave their lands to us as inheritance:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

נַחֲלָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל עַבְדּוֹ,

Inheritance to Israel, His servant:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

שֶׁבַשְׁפִּילָנוּ זָכַר לָנוּ,

That in our humiliation, He remembered us:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

וַיִּפְרֹקֵנוּ מִצָּרֵינוּ,
And that He unburdened us
from our agonies:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

נָתַן לָחֶם לְכָל בָּשָׂר,
Who gives bread to all flesh:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

הוֹדוּ לְאֵל הַשָּׁמַיִם,
Thank The Almighty of the
Heavens:

כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ:

His kindness is neverending!

נְשַׁמֶּת כָּל חַי תְּבָרֵךְ אֶת
שִׁמְךָ יְיָ אֱלֹהֵינוּ, וְרוּחַ כָּל
בָּשָׂר תִּפְאֶרַת וְתִרְוָמָה זְכוֹר
מַלְכֵנוּ תָמִיד. מִן הָעוֹלָם
וְעַד הָעוֹלָם אַתָּה אֵל,
וּמַבְלִעַדֵּיךְ אֵין לָנוּ מֶלֶךְ
גּוֹאֵל וּמוֹשִׁיעַ, פּוֹדֶה וּמַצִּיל
וּמַפְרִיֵּס וּמַרְחֵם בְּכָל עֵת
צָרָה וְצוּקָה. אֵין לָנוּ מֶלֶךְ
אֶלָּא אַתָּה. אֱלֹהֵי
הָרְאשׁוֹנִים וְהָאַחֲרוֹנִים,
אֱלֹהֵי כָל בְּרִיּוֹת, אֲדוֹן כָּל
תּוֹלְדוֹת, הַמְהַלֵּל בָּרַב
הַתְּשַׁבְּחוֹת, הַמְנַהֵג עוֹלָמוֹ

The breath of all living things will
bless Your Name, The Eternal,
our God, and the spirit of all
flesh will glorify and exalt Your
Memory, our King, always. From
universe to universe, You are
The Almighty; and without You
we have no king nor liberator
nor savior — Redeemer, Rescuer,
and Who is merciful at our time
of trouble and distress, we have
no king except You. God of the
Beginnings and the Endings, God
of all beings, Master of all
outcomes, Who is accoladed
with a myriad of praises, Who
guides His universe with
kindness and His creatures with
mercy. And The Eternal never
slumbers nor sleeps, He
awakens sleepers and alerts the

בְּחֶסֶד וּבְרִיּוֹתָיו בְּרַחֲמִים. וַיִּי
לֹא יָנוּם וְלֹא יִישָׁן, הַמַּעֲוִיר
יְשָׁנִים וְהַמְּקִיץ נִרְדָּמִים,
וְהַמְּשִׁיחַ אֲלָמִים וְהַמַּתִּיר
אֲסוּרִים, וְהַסּוֹמֵךְ נוֹפְלִים
וְהַזּוֹקֵף כְּפוּפִים, לָךְ לְבַדְךָ
אֲנַחְנוּ מוֹדִים. אֱלֹהֵינוּ
מִלֹּא שִׁירָה כֵּים, וְלִשְׁוֹנֵנוּ
רֶנָּה כִּהְמוֹן גָּלִיו, וְשִׁפְתוֹתֵינוּ
שֹׁבַח כְּמֶרְחָבִי רָקִיעַ, וְעֵינֵינוּ
מְאִירוֹת כְּשֶׁמֶשׁ וְכִיָּרָח,
וַיִּדְּיֵנוּ פְרוֹשׁוֹת כְּנִשְׁרֵי
שָׁמַיִם, וְרַגְלֵינוּ קָלוֹת
כְּאַיִלוֹת, אֵין אֲנַחְנוּ
מִסְפִּיקִים לְהוֹדוֹת לָךְ, יי
אֱלֹהֵינוּ וְאֱלֹהֵי אֲבוֹתֵינוּ,
וְלִבְרֶךְ אֶת שְׁמֶךָ, עַל אַחַת
מֵאֵלֶּךָ אֲלֹפִי אֲלֹפִים וְרַבִּי
רַבּוֹת פְּעָמִים הַטּוֹבוֹת
שָׁעֲשִׂיתָ עִם אֲבוֹתֵינוּ וְעִמָּנוּ.
מִמִּצְרַיִם גָּאֲלָתָנוּ, יי
אֱלֹהֵינוּ, וּמִבֵּית עַבָדִים
פָּדִיתָנוּ, בְּרָעַב זִנְתָּנוּ וּבְשֹׁבַע
כָּלכַּלְתָּנוּ, מִחֶרֶב הִצַּלְתָּנוּ

drowsy, Who grants speech to
the mute and releases the
emprisoned, and Who supports
the fallen and straightens the
hunched over — to You, You
alone, we acknowledge!

For if our mouths were filled
with song as vast as the ocean, if
our tongues full of joy like the
multitude of its waves, our lips
full of praise as expansive as the
stratosphere, and our eyes
shining like the sun and the
moon, and our hands spread
wide like eagles of the heavens,
and our feet as swift as gazelles
— even with all this it would
never suffice to thank You, The
Eternal Our God and God of our
forefathers, or to praise Your
name for even one of the
thousands and millions and
billions of many good things You
have done for our forefathers
and for us.

From Egypt you liberated us, The
Eternal Our God, and from the
house of slaves You redeemed
us, in hunger You nourished us
and during times of abundance
You provided for us. From the
sword, You rescued us; and from
plague, you gave us sanctuary;
from many unremitting dread

וּמִדְבָּר מִלְטָתָנוּ, וּמִחֲלִים
רָעִים וְרָבִים וְנֶאֱמָרִים
דְּלִיתָנוּ. עַד הֵנָּה עֲזָרוּנוּ
רַחֲמֶיךָ וְלֹא עֲזָבוּנוּ חֲסָדֶיךָ,
וְאַל תִּטְּשֵׁנוּ יְיָ אֱלֹהֵינוּ
לְנֹצֵחַ. עַל כֵּן אֲבָרִים
שֶׁפִּלַּגְתָּ בָנוּ וְרוּחַ וְנִשְׁמָה
שֶׁנִּפְּחַתָּ בְּאַפֵּינוּ וְלִשׁוֹן
אֲשֶׁר שִׁמְתָּ בְּפִינוּ, הֵן הֵם
יֹדוּ וַיְבָרְכוּ וַיִּשְׁבְּחוּ וַיִּפְאֲרוּ
וַיְרוֹמְמוּ וַיַּעֲרִיצוּ וַיִּקְדִּישׁוּ
וַיִּמְלִיכוּ אֶת שִׁמְךָ מִלְכָּנוּ.
כִּי כָל פֶּה לְךָ יוֹדֶה, וְכָל
לִשׁוֹן לְךָ תִּשְׁבַּע, וְכָל בֶּרֶךְ
לְךָ תִּכְרַע, וְכָל קוֹמָה לְפָנֶיךָ
תִּשְׁתַּחֲוֶה, וְכָל לְבָבוֹת
יִירָאוּךָ, וְכָל קָרֵב וּכְלִיּוֹת
יִזְמְרוּ לְשִׁמְךָ, כַּדְּבָר
שֶׁכָּתוּב, כָּל עֲצָמֹתַי
תֹּאמַרְנָה: יְיָ, מִי כָמוֹךָ;
מֵצִיל עָנִי מִחֶזֶק מִמֶּנּוּ וְעָנִי
וְאֲבִיוֹן מִגְּזֻלוֹ. מִי יִדְמָה לָּךְ
וּמִי יִשְׁוֶה לָּךְ וּמִי יַעֲרֶךְ לָּךְ,
הָאֵל הַגָּדוֹל, הַגִּבּוֹר וְהַנּוֹרָא,

diseases You spared us. Until here and now Your mercy has assisted us and Your compassion has not departed us, so never abandon us, The Eternal Our God, ever. Therefore with every facet of our bodies that You designed within us, the spirit and soul that You breathed into our nostrils, and the tongue that You placed in our mouths — these very things will thank and bless and praise and glorify and extol and appreciate and sanctify and crown Your Name, our King.

For every mouth will thank You, every tongue will swear allegiance to You, every knee bend before You, every spine will bow before You, all hearts will be in awe of You, and every fiber of our kidneys will sing Your Name; as the verse states: "All of my bones will say: 'Eternal, who is like You?' You rescue the poor from those who are stronger and the poor and destitute from thieves." Who is like You, who could be compared to You, who could be valued like You; The Great Almighty, mighty and awesome, The Supreme Being Who established heaven and earth? Let us extol and praise and glorify and bless Your Holy

אֶל עֲלִיוֹן, קִנֵּה שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ.
 נְהַלֵּלְךָ וְנִשְׁבַּחְךָ וְנִפְאֶרְךָ
 וְנִבְרַךְ אֶת שֵׁם קְדוֹשְׁךָ,
 כְּאֶמּוּר: לְדוֹד, בְּרַכִּי נִפְשִׁי
 אֶת יי וְכָל קֶרְבִּי אֶת שֵׁם
 קְדוֹשׁוֹ.

Name, as it is written: "As per David: My soul should bless The Eternal and every part of me should bless His Name."

הָאֵל בְּתַעֲצוּמוֹת עֲזָךְ, הַגָּדוֹל
 בְּכְבוֹד שְׁמֶךָ, הַגָּבוֹר לְנִצָּח
 וְהַנּוֹרָא בְּנוֹרְאוּתֶיךָ, הַמֶּלֶךְ
 הַיּוֹשֵׁב עַל כִּסֵּא רָם וְנִשְׂאָ.

The Almighty, in the power of Your strength, great is the honor of Your Name, The Forever Mighty and Who is awesome in Your spectacle, The King that sits on the highest throne above.

שׁוֹכֵן עַד מָרוֹם וְקְדוֹשׁ
 שְׁמוֹ. וְכַתוּב: רַנְּנוּ צְדִיקִים
 בִּיהוָה, לַיֹּשְׁרִים נְאֻה
 תְּהִלָּה.

He Who dwells forever, exalted and holy is His Name. And the verse states: "The righteous rejoice in The Eternal, praise for the honest is fitting."

בְּפִי יֹשְׁרִים תְּתַהַלֵּל,

In the mouths of the honest You will be lauded,

וּבְדַבְרֵי צְדִיקִים תְּתַבָּרְךָ,

and in the words of the righteous You shall be blessed,

וּבִלְשׁוֹן חַסִּידִים תְּתַרְוֶמָּה,

In the tounge of the pious You will be exalted,

וּבִקְרֹב קְדוֹשִׁים תְּתַקַּדֶּשׁ.

and amongst the holy people You shall be sanctified.

וּבִמְקַהֲלוֹת רַבּוֹת עִמָּךְ בֵּית
 יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּרִנָּה יִתְפָּאֵר שְׁמֶךָ,
 מִלְּכֵנוּ, בְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר, שְׁכֵן

And in the gatherings of tens of thousands of Your people, the House of Israel, in joy they will exalt Your Name — Our King! — in every generation. For this is

חֹבֶת כָּל הַיְצוּרִים לְפָנֶיךָ, יי
אֱלֹהֵינוּ וְאֱלֹהֵי אֲבוֹתֵינוּ ,
לְהוֹדוֹת לְהַלֵּל לְשַׁבַּח,
לְפָאֵר לְרוֹמֵם לְהַדִּיר לְבָרֵךְ,
לְעֵלָה וּלְקַלֵּס עַל כָּל דְּבָרֵי
שִׁירֹת וְתַשְׁבְּחוֹת דָּוִד בֶּן
יִשִּׁי עַבְדְּךָ, מְשִׁיחְךָ.

יִשְׁתַּבַּח שְׁמֶךָ לְעַד - מִלְכְּנוּ,
הָאֵל הַמֶּלֶךְ הַגָּדוֹל וְהַקְדוֹשׁ
בְּשָׁמַיִם וּבָאָרֶץ, כִּי לָךְ נָאָה,
יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ וְאֱלֹהֵי אֲבוֹתֵינוּ ,
שִׁיר וְשִׁבְחָה, הַלֵּל וְזִמְרָה,
עֹז וּמִמְשָׁלָה, נֶצַח, גְּדֻלָּה
וּגְבוּרָה, תְּהִלָּה וְתִפְאֶרֶת,
קְדוּשָׁה וּמַלְכוּת, בְּרָכוֹת
וְהוֹדָאוֹת מִעַתָּה וְעַד עוֹלָם.
בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי , אֵל מֶלֶךְ
גָּדוֹל בַּתְּשֻׁבּוֹת, אֵל
הַהוֹדָאוֹת, אֲדוֹן הַנִּפְלְאוֹת,
הַבּוֹחֵר בְּשִׁירֵי זִמְרָה, מֶלֶךְ
אֵל חַי הָעוֹלָמִים.

the obligation of all creations:
before You, The Eternal our God
and God of our forefathers, to
thank and extol and praise and
exalt and elevate and glorify and
raise and acclaim all of the songs
and praises of David, son of
Jesse, Your servant; Your
annointed one.

May Your Name be praised
forever; Our King — The
Almighty Great and Holy King of
Heaven and Earth — for You it is
fitting, The Eternal our God and
God of our forefathers, song and
praise, laud and song, power and
sovereignty, timelessness,
greatness and strength, praise
and glory, holiness and kingship,
blessings and gratitude, now and
forevermore. Blessed are You,
The Eternal, The Almighty Great
King of Praises, God of
Gratitudes, Master of Wonders,
Who chooses melody and song,
The Almighty Life-Granting
King.

Raise your cup of wine and recite the following blessing:

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יי אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ
הָעוֹלָם, בּוֹרֵא פְּרִי הַגֶּפֶן. Blessed are You, The Eternal our
God, King of the Universe; Who
creates the fruit of the vine.

Drink the cup of wine. One should lean to the left while drinking.

The Seder ends with Nirtzah, which is an official proclamation that the essential requirements of the Seder have been fulfilled, followed by songs and poems intended to celebrate the themes of the evening and the holiday as a whole. Most importantly, we specifically celebrate our freedom and hope that next year we will celebrate the holiday in a fully rebuilt Jerusalem.

Additionally, for those who live in the Diaspora, on the second Seder night it is the scheduled time to fulfill the last commandment of the evening — to count the Omer.

Much of the nuance and poetic beauty of the songs and praises in Nirtzah are lost in translation. Rather than attempt to recapture this poetry in another language, the translation instead aims to provide clarity to the overall meaning and sentiment of each piece.

חֲסֵל סֵדוֹר פֶּסַח כְּהִלְכָתוֹ, The Seder has been completed according to its laws,

כָּכֵל מִשְׁפָּטוֹ וְחֻקָּתוֹ. according to each and every law and rule.

כַּאֲשֶׁר זָכִינוּ לְסִדֵּר אוֹתוֹ, Just as we have merited by reciting and discussing it,

כֵּן נִזְכֶּה לַעֲשׂוֹתוֹ. so too we should merit the true execution of the Passover rituals in the future.

זֵךְ שׁוֹכֵן מְעוֹנָה, Purest Being, Who Resides in the Expanse of Heaven,

קוֹמִים קָהָל עֲדַת מִי מִנָּה. raise Your community so that no one can count their number,

בְּקֶרֶב נִהַל נְטָעֵי כִנָּה, soon may You lead the preparations You've planted,

פְּדוּיִם לְצִיּוֹן בְּרִנָּה. redeeming all of us to Zion with joy.

לְשָׁנָה הַבָּאָה בִּירוּשָׁלַיִם
הַבְּנוּיָה! Next year, in a rebuilt Jerusalem!

Outside of Israel, the Seder is performed on both the first and second nights of Passover. On the second night of Passover, the mitzvah of Sefirat HaOmer (the Counting of the Omer) begins.

Every evening for 49 days, the day of Sefirah is counted, leading up until the holiday of Shavuot. The first night of counting the Omer always begins on the second night of Passover, and for those outside of Israel who have a Seder on the second night, it is traditional to count the Omer at this point.

The blessing is first recited, and then the evening is counted. Many have the custom to count the Omer in their native language even after they have already counted in Hebrew.

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְיָ אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ
הָעוֹלָם, אֲשֶׁר קִדְּשָׁנוּ
בְּמִצְוֹתָיו וְצִוָּנוּ עַל סְפִירַת
הָעֹמֶר. Blessed are You, The Eternal our God, King of the Universe; Who commanded us to count the Omer.

הַיּוֹם יוֹם אֶחָד בְּעֹמֶר. Today is the first day of the Omer.

Strictly speaking, the remainder of Nirtzah is optional; however the widely accepted custom is to sing most, if not all, of the songs that follow. Many families have at least one beloved tune that has been passed down for generations, and it is tradition for guests to share their own family tunes with their hosts.

The selection of songs that follow are from popular Ashkenazi custom.

VAYEHI B'CHATZI HALAILAH

The Jewish people were ushered out of Egypt in such a rush that they did not have time to let their dough rise, hence the origin of matzah and the prohibition of *chametz* (leavened products) on Passover. Additionally, the tenth plague — the slaying of the first born — happened exactly at midnight. In an alphabetic series, VaYehi B'Chatzi HaLailah recalls the many miracles and turning points in Jewish history that occurred on or because of the dark hours of the night — thus showing that redemption can come even when it feels like hope is lost.

The three-word refrain is inserted to intentionally segment the text into stanzas, but it does not necessarily punctuate distinct or separate thoughts. Stanzas often break mid-thought to be picked up after the refrain.

Some references, many of which are quite obscure, are indicated in brackets for clarity but are not directly cited in the Hebrew.

For those who live in Diaspora, VaYehi B'Chatzi HaLailah is omitted on the second night.

וּבְכֵן וַיְהִי בַּחֲצִי הַלַּיְלָה And so too, it occurred in the
middle of the night.

אֶז רַב נִסִּים הִפְלִאתָ So many miracles occurred at
בַּלַּיְלָה, night,

בְּרֵאשׁ אֲשֶׁמוֹרֶת זֶה At the beginning of the darkest
הַלַּיְלָה, hours which is night,

גֵּר צֶדֶק נִצְחָתוֹ כְּנֻחַלֵּק לוֹ לַיְלָה, The righteous sojourner [Abraham] won that which was apportioned to him at night [his victory in the Five-vs.-Four Kings War occurred at night];

וַיְהִי בִּחְצֵי הַלַּיְלָה. And it occurred in the middle of the night.

דָּנָה מֶלֶךְ גֶּרָר בַּחֲלוֹם הַלַּיְלָה, The King of Gerar [Avimelech] learned of judgement in his dream at night,

הַפְּחִדָּה אַרְמִי בְּאֶמֶשׁ לַיְלָה, The Aramean [Laban] was frightened in a dream [by God] at night,

וַיִּשְׂר יִשְׂרָאֵל לְמַלְאָךְ וַיּוֹכֵל לוֹ לַיְלָה, And Israel [Jacob] fought with an angel and overpowered him that night;

וַיְהִי בִּחְצֵי הַלַּיְלָה. And it occurred in the middle of the night.

זָרַע בְּכוֹרֵי פַתְרוֹס מַחְצָה בִּחְצֵי הַלַּיְלָה, You smote the firstborn offspring of Patros [i.e. Pharoah] in the middle of the night,

חֵילָם לֹא מָצְאוּ בַּקּוֹמָם בַּלַּיְלָה, His army found no purchase [in the sea] at night,

טִיסַת נָגִיד חַרְשֶׁת סְלִית בְּכוֹכְבֵי לַיְלָה, You paved over the prince of Charoshet [Sisera] with the stars of the night;

וַיְהִי בִּחְצֵי הַלַּיְלָה. And it occurred in the middle of the night.

יַעֲזַן מְחַרֵּף לְנוֹפֵף אֹוִי,
הוֹבִשְׁתָּ פִגְרֵי בַלְיָלָה,
The blasphemous counselor
[Sennacharib] who waved his
hands in mockery [at Jerusalem]
found his armies became dried
corpses at night,

כָּרַע בַּל וּמִצְבוֹ בְּאִישׁוֹן
לַיְלָה,
The Idol of Bale and its
foundation were toppled at
night,

לְאִישׁ חֲמוּדוֹת נִגְלָה רָז
חֲזוֹת לַיְלָה,
And the darling man [Daniel]
was revealed the secrets of
visions at night;

וַיְהִי בַּחֲצִי הַלַּיְלָה.
*And it occurred in the middle of the
night.*

מִשְׁתַּכֵּר בְּכֵלֵי קֹדֶשׁ נִהָרַג
בּוֹ בַלְיָלָה,
He who intoxicated himself from
The Temple's Holy Vessels
[Belshazar] was killed in the
night,

נוֹשַׁע מִבּוֹר אַרְיוֹת פּוֹתָר
בְּעִתּוֹתַי לַיְלָה,
The one saved from the pit of
lions [Daniel] interpreted
phobias of night,

שֹׂנְאָה נָטַר אֶגְגִּי וְכָתַב
סְפָרִים בַּלַּיְלָה,
Hatred that permeated the
Agagite [Haman] and who wrote
his writs of decree at night,

וַיְהִי בַּחֲצִי הַלַּיְלָה.
*And it occurred in the middle of the
night.*

עוֹרְרָתָּ נִצְחָךְ עָלָיו בְּנִדָּד
שֵׁנַת לַיְלָה,
You awakened Your victory over
him [Haman] in the tossing and
turning of a sleepless night,

פּוֹרָה תִּדְרוּךְ לְשׁוֹמֵר מָה
מִלַּיְלָה,
We stomped them like grapes in
a wine vat; we ask the

Watchman [God] "What happened overnight?"

צָרַח בְּשׁוֹמֵר וְשָׁח "אַתָּא
בִּקְרָה וְגַם לַיְלָה",
The Watchman bellows, "The morning has come — and so has the night!"

וַיְהִי בַּחֲצִי הַלַּיְלָה.
And it occurred in the middle of the night.

קָרַב יוֹם אֲשֶׁר הוּא לֹא יוֹם
וְלֹא לַיְלָה,
"Here comes the day that is neither truly day nor truly night!" [i.e. the End of Days]

רַם הוֹדַע כִּי לְךָ הַיּוֹם אַף
לְךָ הַלַּיְלָה,
Most High, announce that all is Yours, both day and even night!

*This next line is often sung all by itself as its own song,
not only on Passover but throughout the year.*

שׁוֹמְרִים הַפִּקְדָּה לְעִירְךָ כָּל
הַיּוֹם וְכָל הַלַּיְלָה,
Appoint watchmen to guard over your city [Jerusalem] every day and every night!

תִּאֲרֵר בְּאוֹר יוֹם חֲשֹׁכֶת
לַיְלָה,
Illuminate, with daylight, the darkest part of night!

וַיְהִי בַּחֲצִי הַלַּיְלָה.
And it occurred in the middle of the night.

V'AMARTEM ZEVAH PESACH

This song focuses on how Passover seems to be a constant time of redemption throughout Jewish history, and this redemption is a fundamental component of what the Paschal Lamb symbolizes. It follows a similar structure and refrain to VaYehi B'Chatzi HaLailah above.

V'Amartem Zevach Pesach is filled with many obscure references and allusions. The bracketed phrases do not appear in the original Hebrew but are instead provided for clarity.

For those who live in Diaspora, V'Amartem Zevach Pesach is omitted on the first night.

וּבְכֵן וַאֲמַרְתֶּם זֶבַח פֶּסַח And so too, you shall refer to the
Passover sacrifice.

אִמְץ גְּבוּרוֹתֶיךָ הַפְּלֵאתָ
בַּפֶּסַח, The might of Your strength you
demonstrated on Passover,

בְּרֵאשׁ כָּל מוֹעֵדוֹת נְשִׂאתָ
פֶּסַח, The first of all holidays, You
uplifted Passover,

גָּלִיתָ לְאַזְרָחִי חֲצוֹת לַיִל
פֶּסַח, You revealed Yourself to Your
citizen [Abraham] on the night of
Passover,

וַאֲמַרְתֶּם זֶבַח פֶּסַח. And you shall refer to the Passover
sacrifice.

דָּלַתְיוֹ דַּפְקָתָ כַּחַם הַיּוֹם
בַּפֶּסַח, On his [Abraham's] door You
knocked in the heat of the day
on Passover,

הִסְעִיד נּוֹצְצִים עֲגוֹת מַצּוֹת
בַּפֶּסַח, He lavished Sparkling Ones
[angels] a feast of matzot on
Passover,

וְאַל הַבָּקָר רָץ זָכָר לְשׁוֹר
עֶרְךָ פֶּסַח, And he ran to [slaughter] the
cattle, which recalls the ox [in
the Torah reading for the
morning of the second day] of
Passover,

וַאֲמַרְתֶּם זִבַּח פֶּסַח. *And you shall refer to the Passover sacrifice.*

זוֹעַמוֹ סְדוֹמִים וְלוֹהֵטוֹ בְּאֵשׁ
בַּפֶּסַח, *Your fury blazingly scorched the people of Sodom on Passover,*

חֵלֶץ לוֹט מֵהֶם וּמִצּוֹת אָפָה
בְּקֶץ פֶּסַח, *Lot extricated himself from them and baked matzot at the end of Passover,*

טָאטְאָתְךָ אֶדְמַת מֹף וְנוֹף
בְּעֶבְרְךָ בַּפֶּסַח, *You swept up the land of Mof & Nof [Egypt] as You passed by on Passover,*

וַאֲמַרְתֶּם זִבַּח פֶּסַח. *And you shall refer to the Passover sacrifice.*

יְהוָה רָאשׁ כָּל אֹן מַחֲצוֹת
בְּלֵיל שְׁמוֹר פֶּסַח, *God, You smote the first of their strength [the Egyptian firstborn] on the Night of Watching — Passover,*

כַּבִּיר, עַל בְּנֵי בְכוֹר פֶּסַח
בְּדָם פֶּסַח, *Grandest, on the firstborn sons You passed over [whose houses] had the blood [on the doorposts which came from the lamb that was sacrificed] for Passover,*

לְבַלְתִּי תֵּת מִשְׁחִית לְבָא
בַּפֶּתַח בַּפֶּסַח, *So as not to give out destruction by coming into the doorways of [those celebrating] Passover,*

וַאֲמַרְתֶּם זִבַּח פֶּסַח. *And you shall refer to the Passover sacrifice.*

מִסְגָּרַת סְגָרָה בְּעִתּוֹתֶיהָ
פֶּסַח, *And the enclosed [Jericho, the walled city] was closed at the*

time of Passover [during the conquest of Joshua],

נִשְׁמָדָה מִדֵּין בַּצָּלִיל שְׁעוּרֵי
עֹמֶר פֶּסַח,

Midian was decimated from an Omer barley cake [which, during Gideon's war against them in the Book of Judges, this giant barley cake appeared to them in a dream and steamrolled their armies, instilling fear and chaos in their camp before their battle] on Passover,

שׁוֹרְפוֹ מִשְׁמֵנֵי פוֹל וְלוֹד
בִּיקָד יְקוֹד פֶּסַח,

The fat [of the Paschal Lambs] of Pul and Lud [Assyria, where some Jewish tribes had been exiled during the reign of King Hezekia; these tribes managed to return to Jerusalem to offer the Paschal Lambs despite their Assyrian captivity] was burned on the bonfire that had been kindled on Passover,

וְאָמַרְתֶּם זֶבַח פֶּסַח.

And you shall refer to the Passover sacrifice.

עוֹד הַיּוֹם בָּנוּב לַעֲמוֹד עַד
גָּעָה עוֹנֵת פֶּסַח,

"Yet today, he [Sennacherib] will stand in Nob" [the first verse of the Haftarah of the eighth day of Passover], until the arrival of the season of Passover,

פֶּס יָד כְּתָבָה לְקַעֲקַע צוֹל
בַּפֶּסַח,

The palmed hand wrote to engrave across [the writing on the wall in the time of Belshazar] on Passover,

צִפֹּה הַצֵּפִית עֲרוֹךְ הַשְּׁלֶחַן
בַּפֶּסַח,

Light the candles, set the table [a reference to Isaiah 21:5, which our Sages teach us was an allusional prophecy to the feast that Belshazar had prepared when the writing on the wall would occur] on Passover,

וְאָמַרְתֶּם זָבַח פֶּסַח.

And you shall refer to the Passover sacrifice.

קָהָל כְּנִסָּה הִדָּסָה לְשֵׁלֶשׁ
צוֹם בַּפֶּסַח,

The community entered Hadassah's [Queen Esther's] three-day fast on Passover,

רָאָשׁ מִבֵּית רָשָׁע מַחֲצֵף
בָּעֵץ חֲמִשִּׁים בַּפֶּסַח,

You smote the head of the wicked house [Haman] on a fifty [cubit] tree on Passover,

שְׁתֵּי אֵלֶּה רָגַע תָּבִיא
לְעוֹצִית בַּפֶּסַח,

Cause these two things [bereavement and widowhood, a reference to Isaiah 47:9] to come to the Uzzite [i.e. Edom, the children of Esau who settled in the land of Uz] on Passover,

תַּעֲזוּ יָדְךָ וְתִרְוִים יְמִינְךָ כְּלִיל
הַתְּקִדֵּשׁ חַג פֶּסַח,

Make a show of force with Your hand and raise Your right hand, as the night You [first] sanctified our festival of Passover,

וְאָמַרְתֶּם זָבַח פֶּסַח.

And you shall refer to the Passover sacrifice.

KI LO NAEH

A king must have citizens, armies, scribes, advisors, supporters, and many others who comprise his kingdom. A powerful king who has the

support of his people not only rules over them, but is also praised and extolled by all of his subjects. Ki Lo Naeh is an alphabetic series of praises proclaiming how God is King Over All and how He is deserving of all praises, ascribing these praises to metaphorical members of His kingdom.

Some customs omit the words in brackets.

כִּי לוֹ נָאֶה, כִּי לוֹ יָאֶה [כָּתֶר
מְלוּכָה]. Because it is proper, Because it
is fitting [the Crown of Kingship].

אֲדִיר בְּמְלוּכָה, בָּחוּר
בְּהִלְכָּה, גְּדוּדָיו יֹאמְרוּ לוֹ: Noble in Kingship, Choicest in all
ways, His forces say of Him:

לְךָ וְלָךְ, לְךָ כִּי לָךְ, לְךָ אֶף
לָךְ, לָךְ יְיָ הַמְּמַלְכָּה, כִּי לוֹ
נָאֶה, כִּי לוֹ יָאֶה [כָּתֶר
מְלוּכָה]. To You, to You — to You because
it is You, to You and only You —
to You, The Eternal, is Kingship
— because it is proper, because it
is fitting [the Crown of
Kingship]!

דָּגוּל בְּמְלוּכָה, הָדוּר
בְּהִלְכָּה, וְתִיקִיו יֹאמְרוּ לוֹ:
לְךָ וְלָךְ, לְךָ כִּי לָךְ, לְךָ אֶף
לָךְ, לָךְ יְיָ הַמְּמַלְכָּה, כִּי לוֹ
נָאֶה, כִּי לוֹ יָאֶה [כָּתֶר
מְלוּכָה]. Paraded in Kingship, Glorious in
all ways, His most senior
advisors say of Him:

To You, to You — to You because
it is You, to You and only You —
to You, The Eternal, is Kingship
— because it is proper, because it
is fitting [the Crown of
Kingship]!

זָכָאִי בְּמְלוּכָה, חֲסִין
בְּהִלְכָּה טַפְסָרָיו יֹאמְרוּ לוֹ:
לְךָ וְלָךְ, לְךָ כִּי לָךְ, לְךָ אֶף
לָךְ, לָךְ יְיָ הַמְּמַלְכָּה, כִּי לוֹ
נָאֶה, כִּי לוֹ יָאֶה [כָּתֶר
מְלוּכָה]. Meritorious in Kingship, Sturdy
in all ways, His scribes say of
Him:

To You, to You — to You because
it is You, to You and only You —

נָאֶה, כִּי לוֹ יָאֶה [כְּתָר
מְלוּכָה].

to You, The Eternal, is Kingship
— because it is proper, because it
is fitting [the Crown of
Kingship]!

יְחִיד בְּמְלוּכָה, כְּבִיר כְּהִלְכָה
לְמוֹדָיו יֹאמְרוּ לוֹ: לְךָ וּלְךָ,
לְךָ כִּי לְךָ, לְךָ אֶף לְךָ, לְךָ יי
הַמְּמַלְכָה, כִּי לוֹ נָאֶה, כִּי לוֹ
יָאֶה [כְּתָר מְלוּכָה].

Unique in Kingship, Grandest in
all ways, His disciples say of Him:

To You, to You — to You because
it is You, to You and only You —
to You, The Eternal, is Kingship
— because it is proper, because it
is fitting [the Crown of
Kingship]!

מוֹשֵׁל בְּמְלוּכָה, נוֹרָא
כְּהִלְכָה סְבִיבֵיו יֹאמְרוּ לוֹ:
לְךָ וּלְךָ, לְךָ כִּי לְךָ, לְךָ אֶף
לְךָ, לְךָ יי הַמְּמַלְכָה, כִּי לוֹ
נָאֶה, כִּי לוֹ יָאֶה [כְּתָר
מְלוּכָה].

Sovereign in Kingship, Awesome
in all ways, His entourage say of
Him:

To You, to You — to You because
it is You, to You and only You —
to You, The Eternal, is Kingship
— because it is proper, because it
is fitting [the Crown of
Kingship]!

עֲנִיו בְּמְלוּכָה, פּוֹדֶה
כְּהִלְכָה, צַדִּיקֵיו יֹאמְרוּ לוֹ:
לְךָ וּלְךָ, לְךָ כִּי לְךָ, לְךָ אֶף
לְךָ, לְךָ יי הַמְּמַלְכָה, כִּי לוֹ
נָאֶה, כִּי לוֹ יָאֶה [כְּתָר
מְלוּכָה].

Humble in Kingship, Redeemer
in all ways, His righteous say of
Him:

To You, to You — to You because
it is You, to You and only You —
to You, The Eternal, is Kingship
— because it is proper, because it
is fitting [the Crown of
Kingship]!

קְדוֹשׁ בְּמִלּוּכָה, רַחוּם
 בְּהִלְכָּה שְׁנֵאֲנֵינוּ יֹאמְרוּ לוֹ:
 לְךָ וּלְךָ, לְךָ כִּי לְךָ, לְךָ אֶפֶר
 לְךָ, לְךָ יְיָ הַמְּמַלְכָּה, כִּי לוֹ
 נָאֵה, כִּי לוֹ יֵאָה [כְּתָר
 מְלוּכָה].

Holy in Kingship, Merciful in all
 ways, His proclaimers say of
 Him:

To You, to You — to You because
 it is You, to You and only You —
 to You, The Eternal, is Kingship
 — because it is proper, because it
 is fitting [the Crown of
 Kingship]!

תְּקִיף בְּמִלּוּכָה, תּוֹמֵךְ
 בְּהִלְכָּה תְּמִימֵינוּ יֹאמְרוּ לוֹ:
 לְךָ וּלְךָ, לְךָ כִּי לְךָ, לְךָ אֶפֶר
 לְךָ, לְךָ יְיָ הַמְּמַלְכָּה, כִּי לוֹ
 נָאֵה, כִּי לוֹ יֵאָה [כְּתָר
 מְלוּכָה].

Resolute in Kingship, Supporter
 in all ways, His perfections say of
 Him:

To You, to You — to You because
 it is You, to You and only You —
 to You, The Eternal, is Kingship
 — because it is proper, because it
 is fitting [the Crown of
 Kingship]!

Adir Hu is a song with a single, simple theme: a request that God speedily rebuild the Holy Temple in Jerusalem. The request is repeated, with each refrain prefixed with a set of praises following the Hebrew alphabet.

אֲדִיר הוּא; יִבְנֶה בֵּיתוֹ	He is noble!
בְּקֶרֶב. בְּמַהֲרָה, בְּמַהֲרָה, בְּיָמֵינוּ בְּקֶרֶב. אֵל בָּנֵה, אֵל בָּנֵה, בָּנֵה בֵּיתְךָ בְּקֶרֶב.	He will build His house soon. Speedily, speedily, soon in our days. Almighty, build! Almighty, build! Build Your house soon!
בְּחֹר הוּא, גָּדוֹל הוּא, דָּגוּל הוּא; יִבְנֶה בֵּיתוֹ בְּקֶרֶב.	He is choicest, He is greatest, He is most paraded!
בְּמַהֲרָה, בְּמַהֲרָה, בְּיָמֵינוּ בְּקֶרֶב. אֵל בָּנֵה, אֵל בָּנֵה, בָּנֵה בֵּיתְךָ בְּקֶרֶב.	He will build His house soon. Speedily, speedily, soon in our days. Almighty, build! Almighty, build! Build Your house soon!
הַדוֹר הוּא, וְתֵיק הוּא, זָכָאי הוּא, חָסִיד הוּא; יִבְנֶה בֵּיתוֹ	He is glorious, He is timeless, He is meritorious, He is pious!
בְּקֶרֶב. בְּמַהֲרָה, בְּמַהֲרָה, בְּיָמֵינוּ בְּקֶרֶב. אֵל בָּנֵה, אֵל בָּנֵה, בָּנֵה בֵּיתְךָ בְּקֶרֶב.	He will build His house soon. Speedily, speedily, soon in our days. Almighty, build! Almighty, build! Build Your house soon!
טָהוֹר הוּא, יָחִיד הוּא, כָּבִיר הוּא, לְמוֹד הוּא, מְלֶכֶּךָ הוּא; יִבְנֶה בֵּיתוֹ בְּקֶרֶב. בְּמַהֲרָה, בְּמַהֲרָה, בְּיָמֵינוּ בְּקֶרֶב. אֵל	He is pure, He is unique, He is grand, He is versed in all, He is King!
	He will build His house soon. Speedily, speedily, soon in our

בְּנֵה, אֵל בְּנֵה, בְּנֵה בִּיתְךָ
בְּקֶרֶב.

days. Almighty, build! Almighty,
build! Build Your house soon!

נוֹרָא הוּא, סָגִיב הוּא, עֲזוּז
הוּא, פּוֹדֶה הוּא, צַדִּיק הוּא;
יְבַנֶּה בֵּיתוֹ בְּקֶרֶב. בְּמַהֲרָה,
בְּמַהֲרָה, בְּיָמֵינוּ בְּקֶרֶב. אֵל
בְּנֵה, אֵל בְּנֵה, בְּנֵה בִּיתְךָ
בְּקֶרֶב.

He is awesome, He is mighty, He
grants all strength, He is The
Redeemer, He is righteous!

He will build His house soon.
Speedily, speedily, soon in our
days. Almighty, build! Almighty,
build! Build Your house soon!

קָדוֹשׁ הוּא, רַחוּם הוּא,
שֶׁדִי הוּא, פֶּקִיד הוּא; יְבַנֶּה
בֵּיתוֹ בְּקֶרֶב. בְּמַהֲרָה,
בְּמַהֲרָה, בְּיָמֵינוּ בְּקֶרֶב. אֵל
בְּנֵה, אֵל בְּנֵה, בְּנֵה בִּיתְךָ
בְּקֶרֶב.

He is holy, He is merciful, He is
The Nurturer, He is resolute!

He will build His house soon.
Speedily, speedily, soon in our
days. Almighty, build! Almighty,
build! Build Your house soon!

WHO KNOWS ONE?

The main purpose of the Seder is to educate children about Jewish history and our collective experience. To this end, Who Knows One is a simple nursery-like repetitive counting song, a format perfectly designed for even the smallest of children to learn, digest, and sing along.

אֶחָד מִי יוֹדֵעַ, אֶחָד אֲנִי
יוֹדֵעַ.

Who knows one? I know one!

אֶחָד אֱלֹהֵינוּ שְׁבַשְׁמַיִם
וּבָאָרֶץ.

One is our God in heaven and on
earth.

שְׁנַיִם מִי יוֹדֵעַ, שְׁנַיִם אֲנִי
יֹדֵעַ. Who knows two? I know two!

שְׁנֵי לְחוֹת הַבְּרִית. אֶחָד
אֱלֹהֵינוּ שְׁבַשְׁמַיִם וּבָאָרֶץ. Two are the Tablets of the Ten
Commandments; One is our God
in heaven and on earth.

שְׁלֹשָׁה מִי יוֹדֵעַ, שְׁלֹשָׁה
אֲנִי יֹדֵעַ. Who knows three? I know three!

שְׁלֹשָׁה אָבוֹת, שְׁנֵי לְחוֹת
הַבְּרִית, אֶחָד אֱלֹהֵינוּ
שְׁבַשְׁמַיִם וּבָאָרֶץ. Three are the patriarchs; Two
are the Tablets of the Ten
Commandments; One is our God
in heaven and on earth.

אַרְבַּע מִי יוֹדֵעַ, אַרְבַּע אֲנִי
יֹדֵעַ. Who knows four? I know four!

אַרְבַּע אִמָּהוֹת, שְׁלֹשָׁה
אָבוֹת, שְׁנֵי לְחוֹת הַבְּרִית,
אֶחָד אֱלֹהֵינוּ שְׁבַשְׁמַיִם
וּבָאָרֶץ. Four are the matriarchs; Three
are the patriarchs; Two are the
Tablets of the Ten
Commandments; One is our God
in heaven and on earth.

חֲמִשָּׁה מִי יוֹדֵעַ, חֲמִשָּׁה
אֲנִי יֹדֵעַ. Who knows five? I know five!

חֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה,
אַרְבַּע אִמָּהוֹת, שְׁלֹשָׁה
אָבוֹת, שְׁנֵי לְחוֹת הַבְּרִית,
אֶחָד אֱלֹהֵינוּ שְׁבַשְׁמַיִם
וּבָאָרֶץ. Five are the Books of the Torah;
Four are the matriarchs; Three
are the patriarchs; Two are the
Tablets of the Ten
Commandments; One is our God
in heaven and on earth.

שֵׁשָׁה מִי יוֹדֵעַ, שֵׁשָׁה אֲנִי
יֹדֵעַ. Who knows six? I know six!

שְׁשֶׁה סִדְרֵי מִשְׁנָה, חֲמִשָּׁה
 חוֹמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה, אַרְבַּע
 אֲמָהוֹת, שְׁלֹשָׁה אָבוֹת, שְׁנֵי
 לְחוֹת הַבְּרִית, אֶחָד אֱלֹהֵינוּ
 שֶׁבַּשְׁמַיִם וּבָאָרֶץ.

Six are the orders of the Mishnah; Five are the Books of the Torah; Four are the matriarchs; Three are the patriarchs; Two are the Tablets of the Ten Commandments; One is our God in heaven and on earth.

שֶׁבַע מִי יוֹדֵעַ, שֶׁבַע אֲנִי
 יוֹדֵעַ.

Who knows seven? I know seven!

שֶׁבַע יְמֵי שַׁבָּתָא, שְׁשֶׁה
 סִדְרֵי מִשְׁנָה, חֲמִשָּׁה
 חוֹמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה, אַרְבַּע
 אֲמָהוֹת, שְׁלֹשָׁה אָבוֹת, שְׁנֵי
 לְחוֹת הַבְּרִית, אֶחָד אֱלֹהֵינוּ
 שֶׁבַּשְׁמַיִם וּבָאָרֶץ.

Seven are the days of the week; Six are the orders of the Mishnah; Five are the Books of the Torah; Four are the matriarchs; Three are the patriarchs; Two are the Tablets of the Ten Commandments; One is our God in heaven and on earth.

שְׁמוֹנֶה מִי יוֹדֵעַ, שְׁמוֹנֶה
 אֲנִי יוֹדֵעַ.

Who knows eight? I know eight!

שְׁמוֹנֶה יְמֵי מִילָה, שֶׁבַע
 יְמֵי שַׁבָּתָא, שְׁשֶׁה סִדְרֵי
 מִשְׁנָה, חֲמִשָּׁה חוֹמְשֵׁי
 תוֹרָה, אַרְבַּע אֲמָהוֹת,
 שְׁלֹשָׁה אָבוֹת, שְׁנֵי לְחוֹת
 הַבְּרִית, אֶחָד אֱלֹהֵינוּ
 שֶׁבַּשְׁמַיִם וּבָאָרֶץ.

Eight are the days until circumcision; Seven are the days of the week; Six are the orders of the Mishnah; Five are the Books of the Torah; Four are the matriarchs; Three are the patriarchs; Two are the Tablets of the Ten Commandments; One is our God in heaven and on earth.

תִּשְׁעָה מִי יוֹדֵעַ, תִּשְׁעָה אֲנִי
יודֵעַ. Who knows nine? I know nine!

תִּשְׁעָה יָרָחִי לֵדָה, שְׁמוֹנָה
יָמֵי מִילָה, שִׁבְעָה יָמֵי
שִׁבְתָּא, שֵׁשָׁה סְדְרֵי מִשְׁנָה,
חֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה,
אַרְבַּע אֲמָהוֹת, שְׁלֹשָׁה
אֲבוֹת, שְׁנֵי לְחוֹת הַבְּרִית,
אֶחָד אֱלֹהֵינוּ שֶׁבַשְׁמַיִם
וּבָאָרֶץ. Nine are the months of
pregnancy; Eight are the days
until circumcision; Seven are the
days of the week; Six are the
orders of the Mishnah; Five are
the Books of the Torah; Four are
the matriarchs; Three are the
patriarchs; Two are the Tablets
of the Ten Commandments; One
is our God in heaven and on
earth.

עֲשָׂרָה מִי יוֹדֵעַ, עֲשָׂרָה אֲנִי
יודֵעַ. Who knows ten? I know ten!

עֲשָׂרָה דְּבָרֵי־א, תִּשְׁעָה יָרָחִי
לֵדָה, שְׁמוֹנָה יָמֵי מִילָה,
שִׁבְעָה יָמֵי שִׁבְתָּא, שֵׁשָׁה
סְדְרֵי מִשְׁנָה, חֲמִשָּׁה
חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה, אַרְבַּע
אֲמָהוֹת, שְׁלֹשָׁה אֲבוֹת, שְׁנֵי
לְחוֹת הַבְּרִית, אֶחָד אֱלֹהֵינוּ
שֶׁבַשְׁמַיִם וּבָאָרֶץ. Ten are the
Ten Commandments; Nine are the
months of pregnancy; Eight are
the days until circumcision;
Seven are the days of the week;
Six are the orders of the
Mishnah; Five are the Books of
the Torah; Four are the
matriarchs; Three are the
patriarchs; Two are the Tablets
of the Ten Commandments; One
is our God in heaven and on
earth.

אֶחָד עָשָׂר מִי יוֹדֵעַ, אֶחָד
עָשָׂר אֲנִי יודֵעַ. Who knows eleven? I know
eleven!

אֶחָד עָשָׂר כּוֹכְבֵּיאַ, עֲשָׂרָה
 דְּבָרִיאַ, תְּשַׁעָה יְרַחֵי לֵדָה,
 שְׁמוֹנָה יָמֵי מִלָּה, שִׁבְעָה
 יָמֵי שִׁבְתָּא, שְׁשָׁה סְדְרֵי
 מִשְׁנָה, חֲמִשָּׁה חֻמְשֵׁי
 תּוֹרָה, אַרְבַּע אֲמָהוֹת,
 שְׁלֹשָׁה אָבוֹת, שְׁנֵי לְחוֹת
 הַבְּרִית, אֶחָד אֱלֹהֵינוּ
 שֶׁבַשְׁמַיִם וּבָאָרֶץ.

Eleven are the stars in Joseph's dream; Ten are the Ten Commandments; Nine are the months of pregnancy; Eight are the days until circumcision; Seven are the days of the week; Six are the orders of the Mishnah; Five are the Books of the Torah; Four are the matriarchs; Three are the patriarchs; Two are the Tablets of the Ten Commandments; One is our God in heaven and on earth.

שְׁנַיִם עָשָׂר מִי יוֹדֵעַ, שְׁנַיִם
 עָשָׂר אֲנִי יוֹדֵעַ.

Who knows twelve? I know twelve!

שְׁנַיִם עָשָׂר שְׁבַטִיאַ, אֶחָד
 עָשָׂר כּוֹכְבֵּיאַ, עֲשָׂרָה
 דְּבָרִיאַ, תְּשַׁעָה יְרַחֵי לֵדָה,
 שְׁמוֹנָה יָמֵי מִלָּה, שִׁבְעָה
 יָמֵי שִׁבְתָּא, שְׁשָׁה סְדְרֵי
 מִשְׁנָה, חֲמִשָּׁה חֻמְשֵׁי
 תּוֹרָה, אַרְבַּע אֲמָהוֹת,
 שְׁלֹשָׁה אָבוֹת, שְׁנֵי לְחוֹת
 הַבְּרִית, אֶחָד אֱלֹהֵינוּ
 שֶׁבַשְׁמַיִם וּבָאָרֶץ.

Twelve are the Tribes of Israel; Eleven are the stars in Joseph's dream; Ten are the Ten Commandments; Nine are the months of pregnancy; Eight are the days until circumcision; Seven are the days of the week; Six are the orders of the Mishnah; Five are the Books of the Torah; Four are the matriarchs; Three are the patriarchs; Two are the Tablets of the Ten Commandments; One is our God in heaven and on earth.

שְׁלֹשָׁה עָשָׂר מִי יוֹדֵעַ,
 שְׁלֹשָׁה עָשָׂר אֲנִי יוֹדֵעַ.

Who knows thirteen? I know thirteen!

שְׁלֹשָׁה עָשָׂר מִדֵּיָא. שְׁנַיִם
 עָשָׂר שְׁבַטֵיָא, אֶחָד עָשָׂר
 כּוֹכְבֵיָא, עֶשְׂרֵה דְּבִרֵיָא,
 תְּשַׁעַה יְרֵחֵי יְלָדָה, שְׁמוֹנָה
 יָמֵי מִילָה, שְׁבַעַה יָמֵי
 שְׁבֻתָא, שְׁשָׁה סְדְרֵי מְשֻנָּה,
 חֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה,
 אַרְבַּע אֲמָהוֹת, שְׁלֹשָׁה
 אָבוֹת, שְׁנֵי לְחוֹת הַבְּרִית,
 אֶחָד אֱלֹהֵינוּ שְׁבַע־שָׁמַיִם
 וּבְאָרֶץ.

Thirteen are the Divine Attributes of Mercy; Twelve are the Tribes of Israel; Eleven are the stars in Joseph's dream; Ten are the Ten Commandments; Nine are the months of pregnancy; Eight are the days until circumcision; Seven are the days of the week; Six are the orders of the Mishnah; Five are the Books of the Torah; Four are the matriarchs; Three are the patriarchs; Two are the Tablets of the Ten Commandments; One is our God in heaven and on earth.

CHAD GADYA

While at first glance Chad Gadya seems unconnected to the themes expressed in the Seder, it is all about how events are interconnected. It begins with a loss but builds towards triumph, and the poor goat never even realizes that he is the beginning of the ultimate redemption. Similarly, the Jewish people can never really completely know *how* God orchestrates their destiny — but we can nonetheless celebrate that destiny, knowing that God is behind everything that happens.

חַד גָּדִיָא, חַד גָּדִיָא One goat — just one goat.

דְּזָבִין אַבָּא בְּתָרֵי זוּזִי, חַד
 גָּדִיָא, חַד גָּדִיָא. One goat, just one goat; that
 father bought for two coins.

וְאַתָּה שׁוֹנָרָא וְאַכְלָה
 לְגָדִיָא, דְּזָבִין אַבָּא בְּתָרֵי And along came a cat that ate
 the goat — One goat, just one

זוּי, חַד גִּדְיָא, חַד גִּדְיָא. goat; that father bought for two coins.

וְאַתָּא כְּלָבָא וְנֶשֶׁךְ
לְשׁוֹנָרָא, דְּאָכַלָּה לְגִדְיָא,
דְּזָבִין אָבָא בְּתָרֵי זוּי, חַד
גִּדְיָא, חַד גִּדְיָא.

And along came a dog that bit the cat that ate the goat — One goat, just one goat; that father bought for two coins.

וְאַתָּא חוּטְרָא וְהִכָּה
לְכְּלָבָא, דְּנֶשֶׁךְ לְשׁוֹנָרָא,
דְּאָכַלָּה לְגִדְיָא, דְּזָבִין אָבָא
בְּתָרֵי זוּי, חַד גִּדְיָא, חַד
גִּדְיָא.

And along came a stick that hit the dog that bit the cat that ate the goat — One goat, just one goat; that father bought for two coins.

וְאַתָּא נוּרָא וְשַׁרְף
לְחוּטְרָא, דְּהִכָּה לְכְּלָבָא,
דְּנֶשֶׁךְ לְשׁוֹנָרָא, דְּאָכַלָּה
לְגִדְיָא, דְּזָבִין אָבָא בְּתָרֵי
זוּי, חַד גִּדְיָא, חַד גִּדְיָא.

And along came a fire that burnt the stick that hit the dog that bit the cat that ate the goat — One goat, just one goat; that father bought for two coins.

וְאַתָּא מַיָּא וְכַבָּה לְנוּרָא,
דְּשַׁרְף לְחוּטְרָא, דְּהִכָּה
לְכְּלָבָא, דְּנֶשֶׁךְ לְשׁוֹנָרָא,
דְּאָכַלָּה לְגִדְיָא, דְּזָבִין אָבָא
בְּתָרֵי זוּי, חַד גִּדְיָא,
חַד גִּדְיָא.

And along came water that doused the fire that burnt the stick that hit the dog that bit the cat that ate the goat — One goat, just one goat; that father bought for two coins.

וְאַתָּא תוּרָא וְשָׁתָה לְמַיָּא,
דְּכַבָּה לְנוּרָא, דְּשַׁרְף
לְחוּטְרָא, דְּהִכָּה לְכְּלָבָא,

And along came an ox that drank the water that doused the fire that burnt the stick that hit the dog that bit the cat that ate the

דִּנְשֵׁךְ לְשׁוֹנָרָא, דְּאֶכְלָה
לְגִדְיָא, דְּזָבִין אֲבָא בְּתָרִי
זוּזִי, חַד גִּדְיָא, חַד גִּדְיָא.

goat — One goat, just one goat;
that father bought for two coins.

וְאַתָּא הַשׁוֹחֵט וְשַׁחַט
לְתוֹרָא, דְּשִׁתָּה לְמִיָּא,
דְּכָבָה לְנוֹרָא, דְּשַׁרְף
לְחוּטְרָא, דְּהִכָּה לְכַלְבָּא,
דִּנְשֵׁךְ לְשׁוֹנָרָא, דְּאֶכְלָה
לְגִדְיָא, דְּזָבִין אֲבָא בְּתָרִי
זוּזִי, חַד גִּדְיָא, חַד גִּדְיָא.

And along came a butcher that
slaughtered the ox that drank
the water that doused the fire
that burnt the stick that hit the
dog that bit the cat that ate the
goat — One goat, just one goat;
that father bought for two coins.

וְאַתָּא מַלְאַךְ הַמָּוֶת וְשַׁחַט
לְשׁוֹחֵט, דְּשַׁחַט לְתוֹרָא,
דְּשִׁתָּה לְמִיָּא, דְּכָבָה לְנוֹרָא,
דְּשַׁרְף לְחוּטְרָא, דְּהִכָּה
לְכַלְבָּא, דִּנְשֵׁךְ לְשׁוֹנָרָא,
דְּאֶכְלָה לְגִדְיָא, דְּזָבִין אֲבָא
בְּתָרִי זוּזִי, חַד גִּדְיָא, חַד
גִּדְיָא.

And along came the Angel of
Death that slayed the butcher
who slaughtered the ox that
drank the water that doused the
fire that burnt the stick that hit
the dog that bit the cat that ate
the goat — One goat, just one
goat; that father bought for two
coins.

וְאַתָּא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא
וְשַׁחַט לְמַלְאַךְ הַמָּוֶת,
דְּשַׁחַט לְשׁוֹחֵט, דְּשַׁחַט
לְתוֹרָא, דְּשִׁתָּה לְמִיָּא,
דְּכָבָה לְנוֹרָא, דְּשַׁרְף
לְחוּטְרָא, דְּהִכָּה לְכַלְבָּא,

And along came The Holy One,
Blessed Be He; Who slayed the
Angel of Death that slayed the
butcher who slaughtered the ox
that drank the water that
doused the fire that burnt the
stick that hit the dog that bit the
cat that ate the goat — One goat,

דִּנְשֵׁךְ לְשׁוֹנָרָא, דְּאַכְלָה just one goat; that father bought
לְגִדְיָא, דְּזָבִין אַבָּא בְּתֵרִי for two coins.
זוּזִי, חַד גִּדְיָא, חַד גִּדְיָא.

The Seder ends here.

Despite this, all participants are encouraged to continue celebrating the Exodus from Egypt, praising God for His kindness and His direction, and studying Jewish law and tradition.

”והמים להם חומה

מימינם ומשמאלם“

*“And the water was to them like a wall
from their right
and from their left”*